

The form entered in the settings will be used for the graphical output. However, a form entered in the default settings takes precedence. In the example, the entered form is the terminal strip definition form.

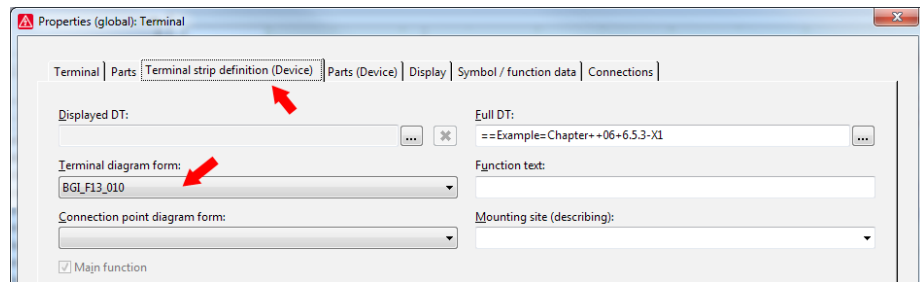


Fig. 6.91 Setting the default form

When you click OK, EPLAN asks about possible sorting and filter criteria, generates the report for the current data, and hangs the graphical output on the cursor. This can now be placed on the current page.

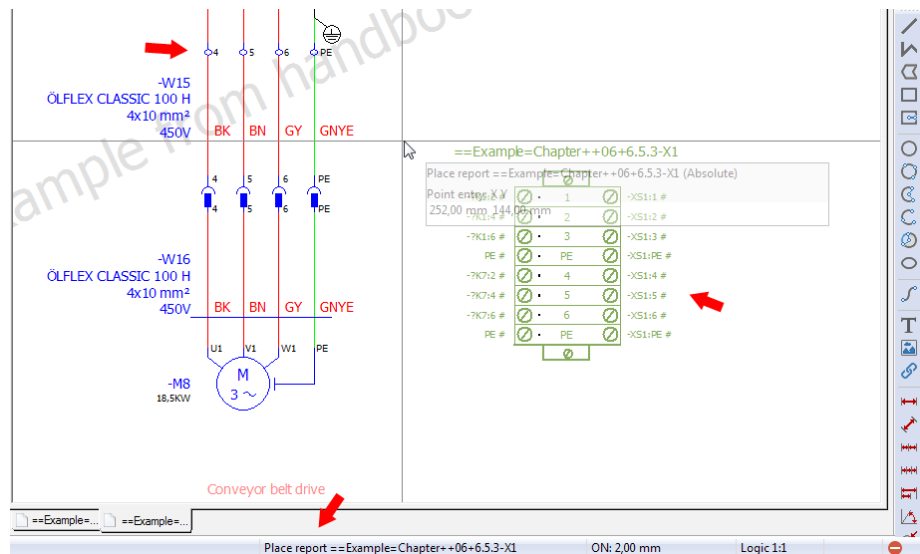


Fig. 6.92 Manually placing the report

This gives you a simple way to output the data (as a report) on the page the data is on, without having to tediously search through a manual selection list for the exact data.

### 6.5.2.3 Manual selection of specific project data for graphical output with manual placement

When reports are generated as described above, then either all project data or only specific data (on the current page) is output. This means that if the project contains ten terminal strips, then all of these ten terminal strips are output to the project as graphical report pages (depending on the settings in the terminal strip definition, e.g. **<20851 No output to terminal/plug diagram>**).

In the following, data is selected via manual selection, but not on new report pages as in section 6.5.2.2; instead, the data is manually placed on existing schematic pages.



**TIP:** Before you use the *Manual placement* function, the schematic page where the report will finally be placed must be open and active. You can no longer scroll between the pages once the report has been generated.

Manual placement works in principle with all form sizes (in this case the graphical extent of the form), but the form should be suitable for the respective schematic page – optically and in terms of space and the data to be output.

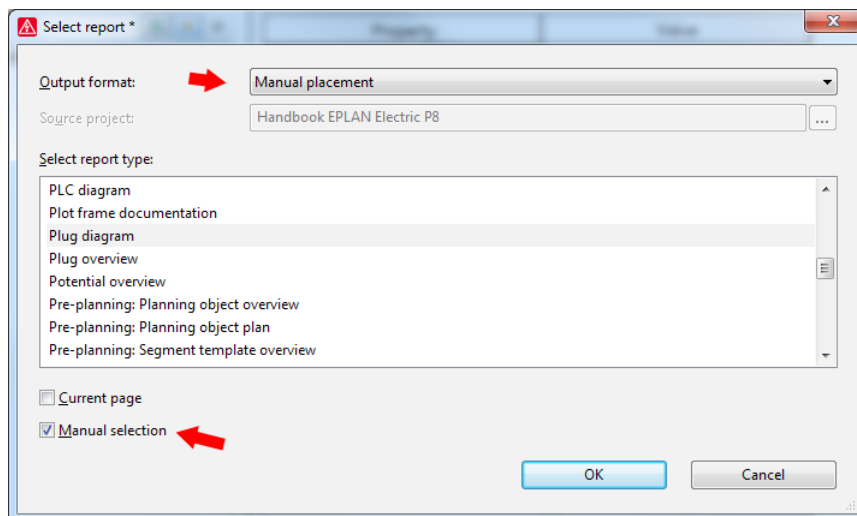


Fig. 6.93 Selecting a report

The **Manual selection** option allows you to define which particular project data is to be output, e.g. specific plug strips. Select the corresponding report and activate the **Manual selection** option. The data should be placed on an active schematic page. You do this by setting the output format to **Manual placement**. Then you can confirm the dialog by clicking OK.

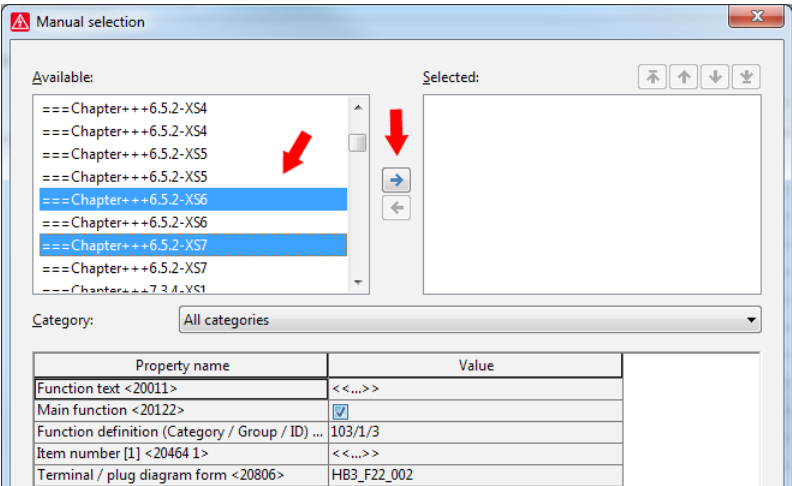


Fig. 6.94 Manual selection of project data

The **MANUAL SELECTION** dialog is then displayed. The left side of the dialog shows all data that is *available* for the selected report. You use the buttons with the blue arrows to add the desired data to the *Selected* field at the right of the dialog. The  button inserts data from left to right. The lower button  (which is only available when there is data in the right field) removes the selected data from the selection.

You select the data via **CTRL** (or **SHIFT**) + left mouse button, or you can use the usual Windows functions such as **CTRL + A** (select all). To select data, the cursor must be located either in the left (*Available*) field or the right (*Selected*) field of the dialog.

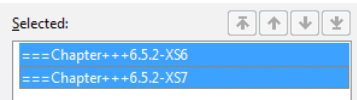


Fig. 6.95  
Selected data

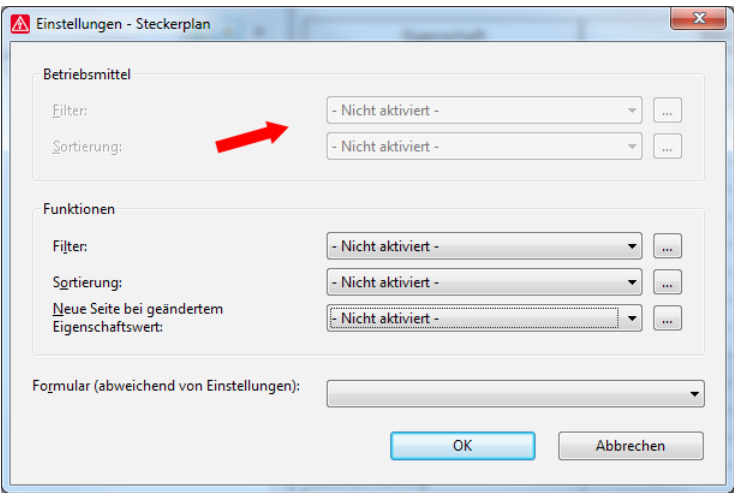


Fig. 6.96 Filter and sorting options for manually selected functions

When you click OK, EPLAN displays the familiar FILTER/SORTING [REPORT TYPE] dialog. Filters and sorting cannot be selected for devices because these were already manually selected. Filters and sorting can, however, be used for the functions themselves (data such as plug pin or terminal).

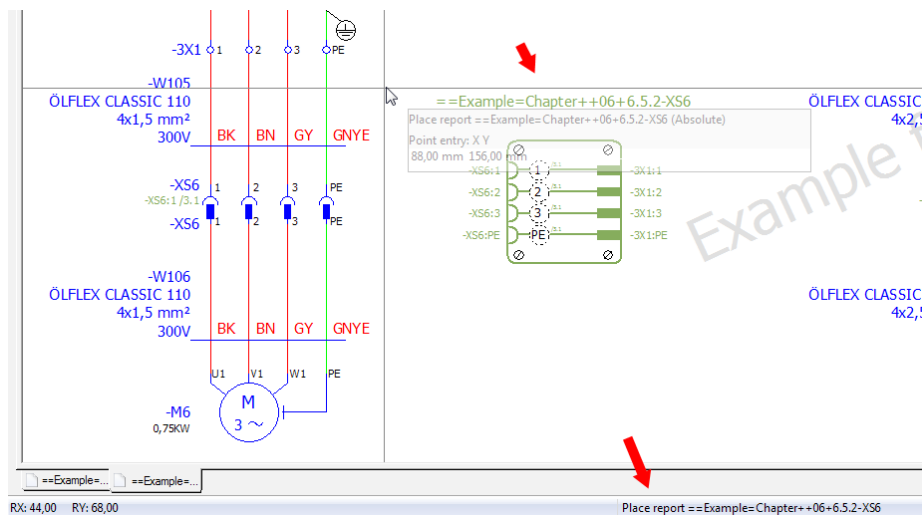


Fig. 6.97 Manually placing the report

When you click OK, EPLAN closes all dialogs. The reports hang on the cursor and can now be placed on the active schematic page.

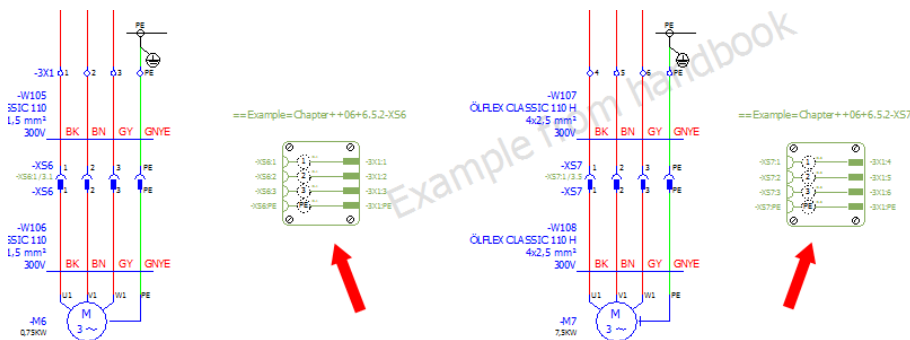


Fig. 6.98 Manually placed reports



**NOTE:** The **Manual selection** option cannot be used with all report types.

6.5.2.4 Graphical output of data using the Current page/Manual selection combination

The Current page and Manual selection options can also be combined.

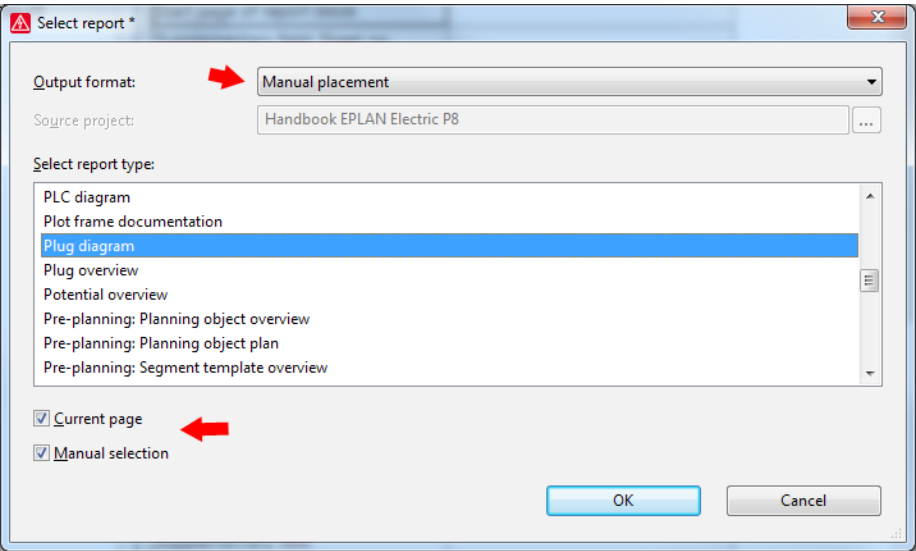


Fig. 6.99 Combining both options for the graphical output of the data

All data on the current page will be used for graphical output, but you now can manually intervene and, for example, remove a terminal strip from the graphical output.

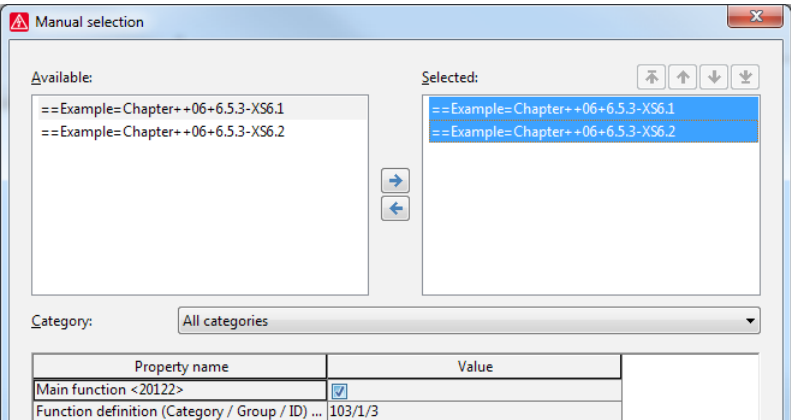


Fig. 6.100 Selecting page data

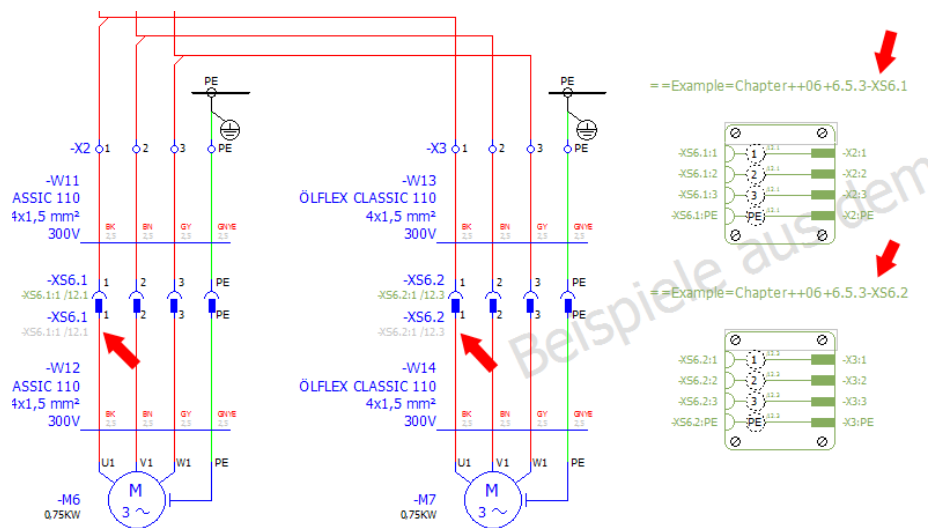


Fig. 6.101 Data has been placed

### 6.5.3 Popup menus in the Reports tab

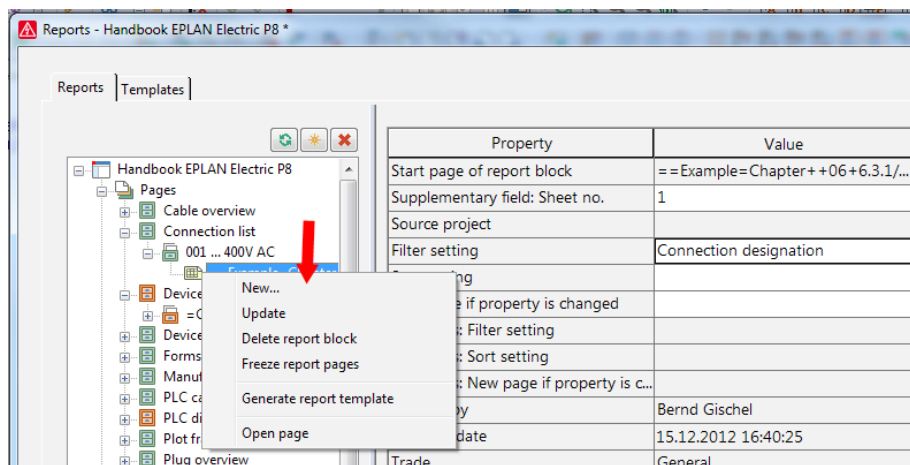


Fig. 6.102 Popup menu in the Reports tab

There are a number of other functions in addition to the previously described functions, such as **Creating reports** and **Manually placing reports**. Reports should, of course, be able to be deleted, or quickly updated from within the dialog (e.g. after changing a setting).

These functions can be accessed, for example, in the right-click popup menu (click a field in the *Reports* tab with the left mouse button and then click the right mouse button to confirm). The menu contains the following functions.

*New*: Creates a new report.

*Update*: This function updates one or more reports. This is useful when, for example, you have changed the report sorting and wish to quickly check where the graphical output pages were placed.

*Delete report block*: Removes the reports (i.e. the graphical output pages) from the project. Here too, you can delete one or more reports at the same time.

*Freeze report block*: “Freezes” the selected reports and removes them from the list of reports in the dialog. EPLAN displays a safety warning before executing this function. This allows you to cancel the action before it is executed.

*Create report template*: If a report is suitable for creating new reports, then you can click here to create a template from it. The template can then be found in the *Templates* tab.

*Open page*: This is a useful function that allows the user to directly navigate to the selected report in the project.

## 6.5.4 Generate reports with templates

What are *templates*? You could describe this term in another way. These are special *defaults* that define how, where, and to what extent EPLAN is to generate the graphical output of various project data. The procedure for creating a template is the same as that for creating regular reports, except that no reports are generated when the template is finished.

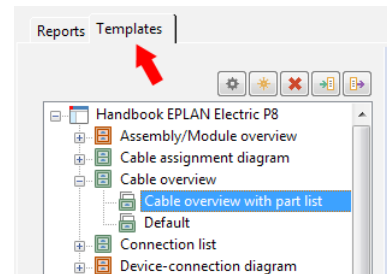


Fig. 6.103  
The Templates tab



**NOTE:** The following restrictions apply to the use of templates to generate reports: The *output form* is fixed in the *Page* selection. A *manual selection* cannot be defined.

And how are templates created? The “how” involves a number of different settings for a template.

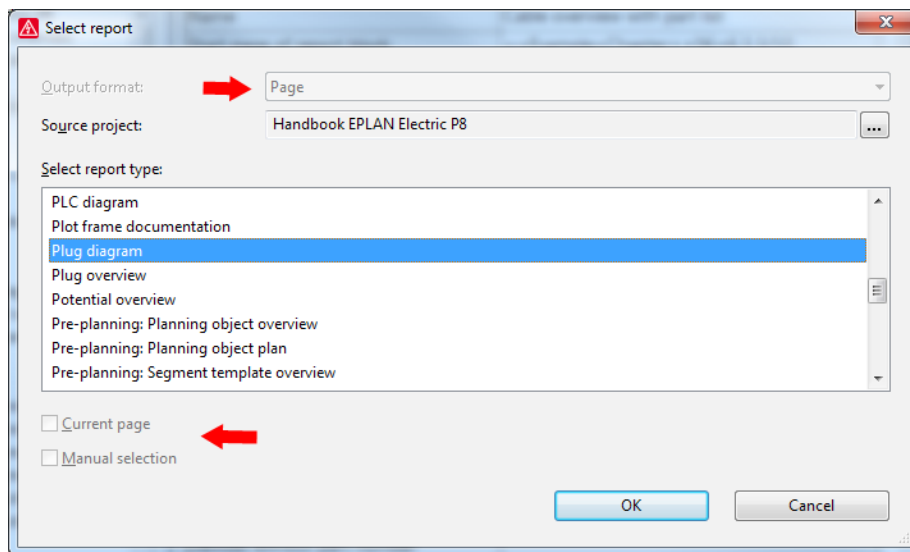


Fig. 6.104 Selecting a report type

To define the report type, you open the **REPORTS** dialog via the **UTILITIES/REPORT/GENERATE** menu and switch to the *Templates* tab. Use the **NEW** button to start the **SELECT REPORT** dialog. You now select the desired *report type* here. Confirm your selection with **OK**.

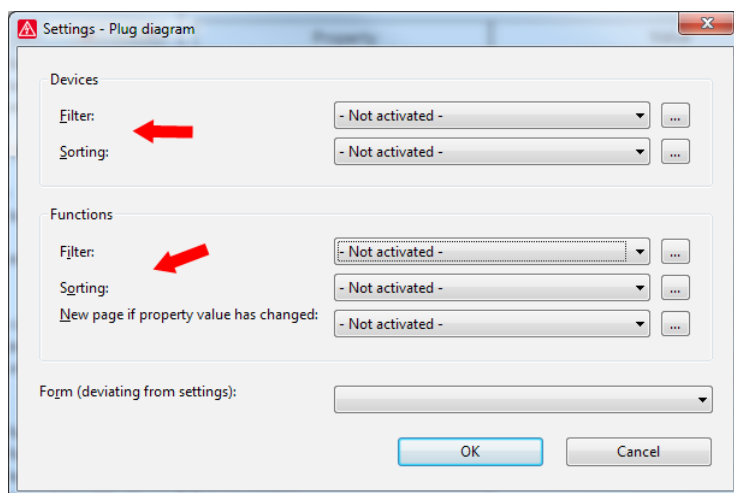


Fig. 6.105 The Filter / sorting dialog

As usual in EPLAN, you can use predefined filter and sorting options, or set up your own, in the **SETTINGS [REPORT TYPE]** dialog. However, you must always make sure that the check boxes are correctly set, otherwise the filter and sorting options will not be active.



**NOTE:** Depending on the report type, the **SETTINGS** dialog may look different, or a few of the options might not be displayed at all (grayed out).

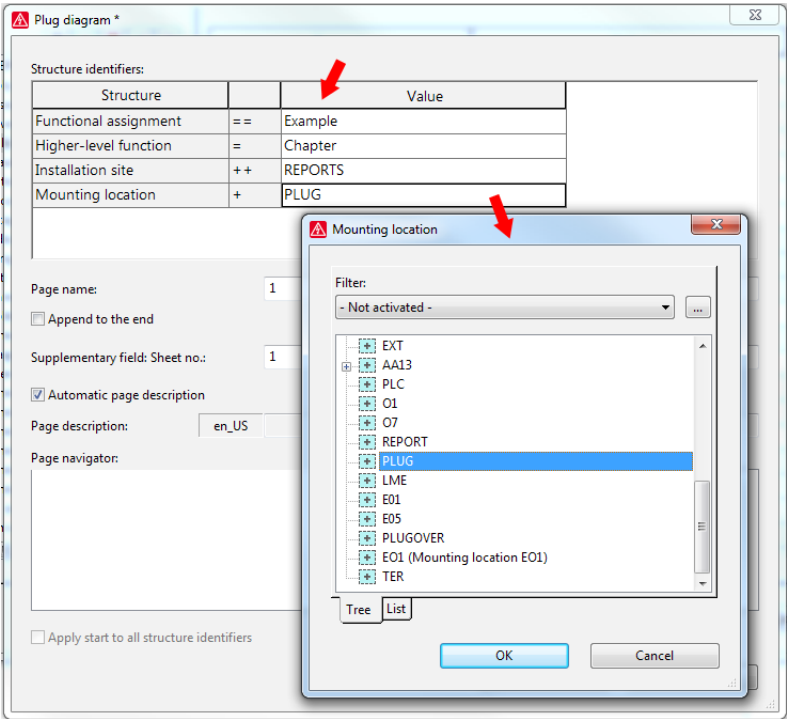


Fig. 6.106 Setting the structure of report pages

After you have selected any data filters and sorting, the *Selection of structure identifier* dialog for the output of report pages opens. The structure identifiers can be directly entered into the data entry fields or, if they already exist, they can be selected and applied from a table via the  selection button.

**NOTE:** EPLAN initially automatically sorts new identifiers into the project's identifier structure. If these need to be rearranged, then this must be done later in structure identifier management.

EPLAN now adds the template and its settings to the *Templates* tab. In order to keep templates functionally separate, EPLAN automatically assigns a certain structure to them when they are created (according to report type). The initial template is given the default name 1. The second would be number 2, and so on.

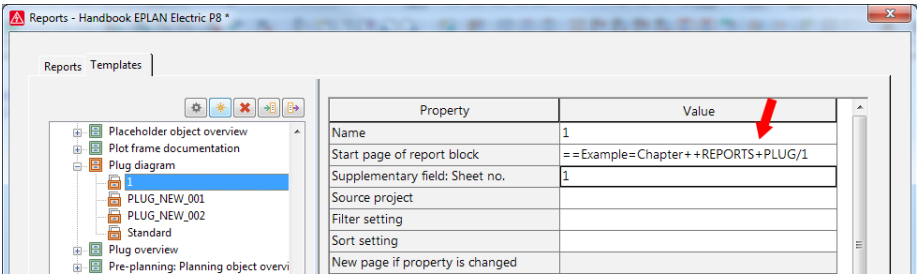


Fig. 6.107 Template addition complete

 **NOTE:** If filters were selected previously, EPLAN assigns the filter's name to the template.

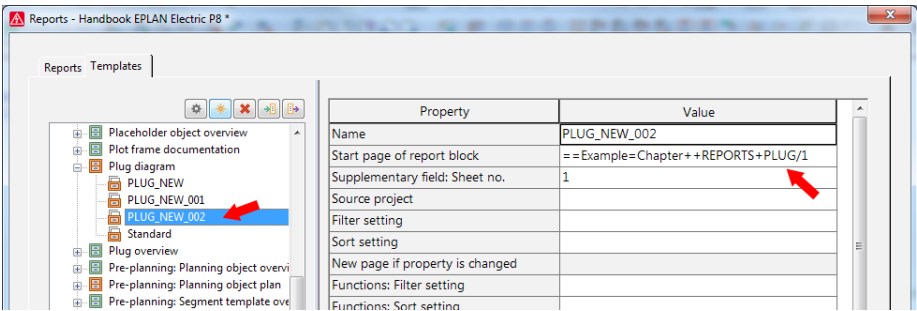


Fig. 6.108 Template name changed

Because there can be several templates generating report types, it is possible to manually change the names of templates later. You click in the **PROPERTY - NAME: VALUE** line and simply enter another name.

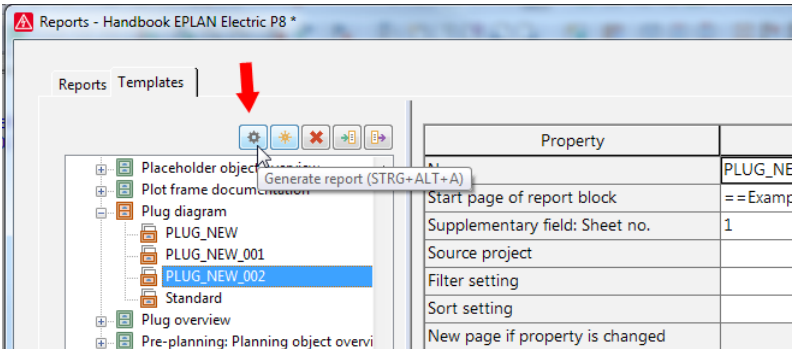


Fig. 6.109 Generate this template report

This completes the generation of a template. If you now select this template and click the  button, EPLAN will generate the report pages and sort them in the predefined structure of the project.

This and other information can be seen at the *right side* of the *Templates* tab. The table shows additional properties and their associated values. In contrast to the *Reports* tab (which also has this table), here you can change the corresponding values of (some) properties.

Other properties of the  
Templates tab

| Property                                  | Value                               |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Name                                      | Full edition                        |
| Start page of report block                | =Example=Chapter++REPORTS+6         |
| Supplementary field: Sheet no.            | 1                                   |
| Source project                            |                                     |
| Filter setting                            |                                     |
| Sort setting                              |                                     |
| New page if property is changed           |                                     |
| Functions: Filter setting                 |                                     |
| Functions: Sort setting                   |                                     |
| Functions: New page if property is cha... |                                     |
| Trade                                     | General                             |
| Manual page description                   |                                     |
| Automatic page description                | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Page sorting                              | From settings                       |
| Form                                      | HB4_F01_005                         |
| Partial output                            | HB3_F01_004                         |

Fig. 6.110 Basic properties for structure and output

*Name:* Contains the name of the template. It can be manually changed to suit your personal requirements.

*Start page of the report block:* This is the start page of the graphical output and can be later changed. To change the name, click the field and then click the  selection button that appears. The familiar dialog for **ENTERING THE STRUCTURE IDENTIFIER** is then displayed.

*Supplementary field: Sheet no.:* Additional information that appears in the page properties of the report pages.

*Source project:* Displays the name of the source project that has (may have) been specified in the **SELECT REPORT** dialog in the *Source project* field. This field allows for different source project to be selected via the More button.

*Filter setting:* This field is filled with the selected filter settings and can also be changed when you click it. You can then use the  selection button to can assign a new filter scheme.

*Sort setting:* Can be subsequently changed in exactly the same way as the **Filter setting** property.

*New page if property is changed:* Allows you to enter a default value that causes an automatic page break when the value of a particular property changes. This is not to be confused with breaks in the case of changes to functions.

*Functions: Filter/Sort setting and New page if property is changed:* These filters operate directly on the device functions, e.g. on a terminal.

*Trade:* Selection of and/or change to the trade. Generally, this property does not have to be changed, because EPLAN selects the correct one automatically.

*Manual page description:* Can also be subsequently changed.

*Automatic page description:* When this property is activated, the **Manual page description** property can no longer be edited.

*Page sorting:* This field is usually filled with the **From settings** entry, because the basic values have already been set in the default settings (OUTPUT TO PAGES SETTING). However, this value can still be changed.

|                               |                                     |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Automatic page description    | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Page sorting                  | From settings                       |
| Form                          | HB4_F01_005                         |
| Partial output                | HB3_F01_004                         |
| Break up assemblies           | From settings                       |
| Break up modules              | From settings                       |
| Devices without part number   | From settings                       |
| Terminal strip parts          | From settings                       |
| Terminal parts                | From settings                       |
| Cable parts                   | From settings                       |
| Cable connection part         | From settings                       |
| Cable project parts           | From settings                       |
| Connection parts              | From settings                       |
| Plug parts                    | From settings                       |
| Pin parts                     | From settings                       |
| Busbar parts                  | From settings                       |
| Busbar connection point parts | From settings                       |
| Pre-planning part             | From settings                       |
| Project filter                | FACTORY_PRINT_OK                    |
| Template active               | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Action                        |                                     |

Fig. 6.111 Further properties for report output

*Form:* Here you can enter a different form to that specified in the default settings (OUTPUT TO PAGES SETTING). This form then has priority over the global settings.

*Partial output:* Can be changed, but only for certain report types that support partial output, such as the table of contents.

|                             |               |
|-----------------------------|---------------|
| Break up modules            | From settings |
| Devices without part number | From settings |
| Terminal strip parts        | From settings |
| Terminal parts              | From settings |
| Cable parts                 | Yes           |
| Cable connection part       | No            |
| Cable project parts         | From settings |

Fig. 6.112 Properties that affect parts output

*Break up assemblies and Break up modules; Device without part number; other additional settings for terminals, cables, project and connection parts:* These settings can be changed later but they only affect some of the *part* report types.

|                 |                                     |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------|
| Project filter  | FACTORY_PRINT_OK                    |
| Template active | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Action          |                                     |

Fig. 6.113 Special report settings

*Project filter:* Setting a project filter enables you to generate reports that are linked to a condition. You can generate conditional reports independently of certain project properties.

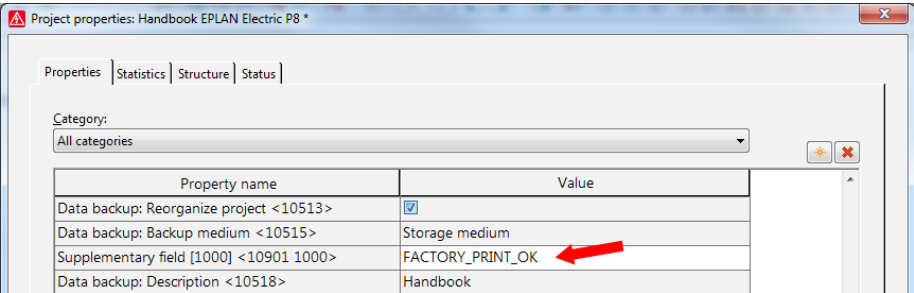


Fig. 6.114 Selecting a project property and defining its value

This means that if a defined project property's value matches the filter value, a report will be generated.

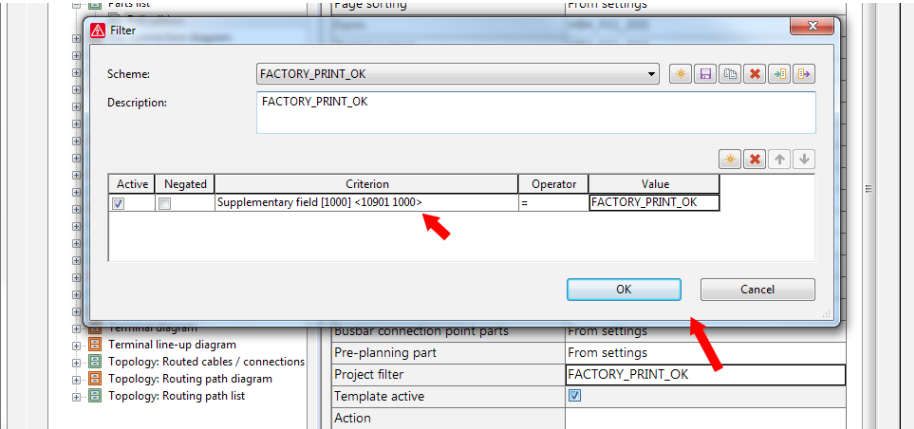


Fig. 6.115 Selecting a filter for the desired project property and its value

*Template active:* This setting cannot be edited; it is automatically set or not set by EPLAN. The check box depends on whether the project filter was fulfilled or not. When the condi-

tion is fulfilled, the check box is set; when the condition is not fulfilled, EPLAN removes the check. This means that no report will be generated.

#### 6.5.4.1 Export and import of templates

Once you have created useful templates for graphical reports in a project, EPLAN can also use these for other projects. EPLAN provides *export and import functions* for this. However, this applies only to templates. Existing reports cannot be exported or imported.

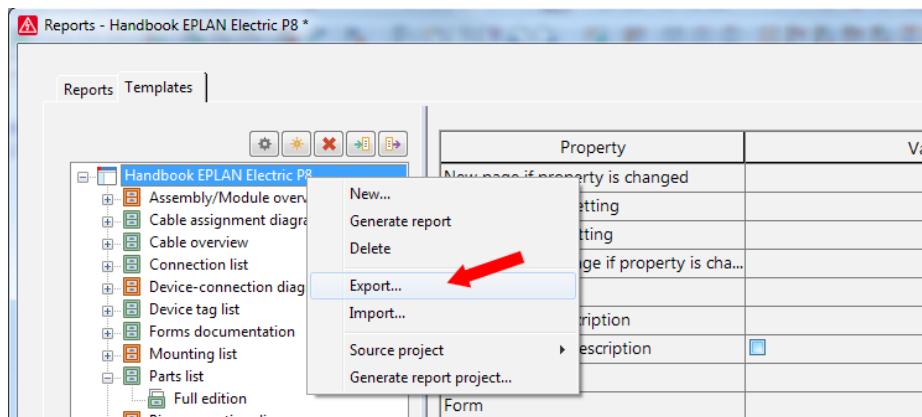


Fig. 6.116 Export/Import templates

To export or import templates, you open the **REPORTS** dialog via the **UTILITIES/REPORTS/GENERATE** menu. If not immediately displayed, then switch to the *Templates* tab. You access the *Export* and *Import* functions via the popup menu (right mouse button).

EPLAN allows the user to decide which templates to export and import. If the tree is selected at the highest level, for example, then all templates below this are exported together. You can also export individual templates. Expand the template tree, select the desired template only, and run the *Export* function. EPLAN then displays the **EXPORT REPORT TEMPLATES** dialog. Select a file name for the template and then save it by clicking the **SAVE** button. The template is then exported.

Importing existing templates functions in exactly the reverse direction. You open the **REPORTS** dialog and start the *Import* function (right mouse button or popup menu). EPLAN opens the **IMPORT REPORT TEMPLATES** dialog. Here you select the desired template and open it via the **OPEN** button. EPLAN now inserts the new template into the project.

## ■ 6.6 Other functions

You will normally not just constantly create new reports and develop pretty templates for reports. Reports with particular report types are usually not completely finished until the end of project editing and then only updated when project data changes, such as terminal designations or a different cable type. EPLAN offers two more functions that allow this to be done quickly.

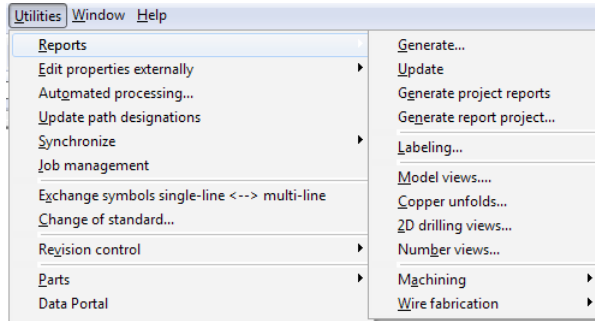


Fig. 6.117 Generate project (templates) reports

### 6.6.1 Update

An additional function that EPLAN offers is the *Update* function for *existing* reports. This function is also available in the UTILITIES/REPORTS menu via the  button. In contrast to the *Generate project reports* function, the *Update* function always only affects the currently open report(s) or a report selected in the page navigator (a page, but can also be a manually placed report) in the project.

If you run the *Update* function, the selected report is updated. If the update function is used on a schematic page, for example, EPLAN will display a prompt.

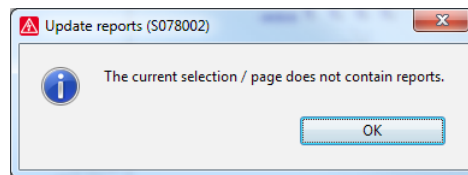


Fig. 6.118 Updating reports – no report selected

### 6.6.2 Generate project reports

The *Generate project reports* function is accessed via the UTILITIES/REPORTS menu. If you select this function, all of the reports (that exist as report templates) are evaluated completely. For large projects, this can take a while.



**TIP:** Once the menu item has been selected, EPLAN begins project evaluation immediately (without any prompt dialogs). You can, however, use the **CANCEL** button in the **GENERATE PROJECT REPORTS** dialog to immediately exit the function. The reports then remain in their original state or are returned to their original state.

### 6.6.3 Generate report project

This menu item is used to define a report project. Using the open project (source project), EPLAN generates an identical project (report project), including the header data, but without pages. This makes it possible to later output the data reports in the source project to the external project report.

### 6.6.4 Settings for automatic updates

If this is not enough for you, then you can also enter a user setting that defines whether or not report pages should be automatically updated when opened, printed, or exported. This is not a project setting but rather a user-specific setting. It is located in the **OPTIONS/SETTINGS/USER/DISPLAY/GENERAL** menu. The two relevant settings are *Update reports when opening pages* and *Update reports when printing and exporting*.

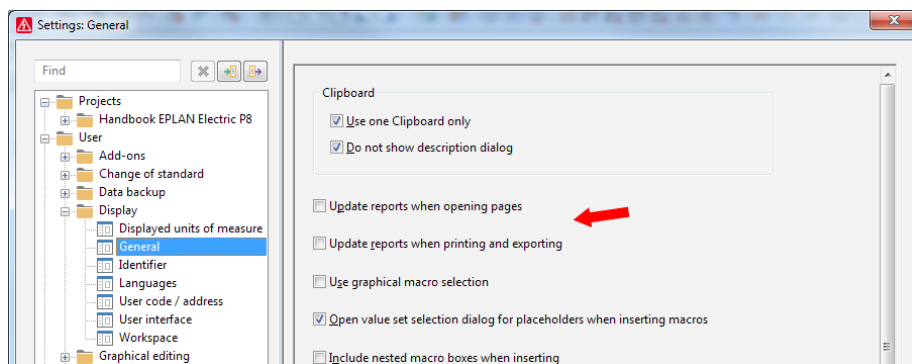


Fig. 6.119 Settings for automatically updating reports



However, you should note that this type of constant updating slows down project editing, e.g. when scrolling through project pages. Opening report pages also takes longer when this user setting is active because the reports are always brought up-to-date and cannot be displayed any time sooner.

You should therefore carefully consider whether or not the report pages should be constantly kept up-to-date. In my opinion, this is not absolutely necessary, but EPLAN offers this setting. It is up to the user to decide.

## ■ 6.7 Labeling

The second way to generate a report from project data is via the function under the **UTILITIES/REPORTS/LABELING** menu item. This function does not generate graphical report pages but rather writes the project data to external files. These external files can then be passed on and subsequently edited, for example to print terminal diagrams in Excel format or labels.

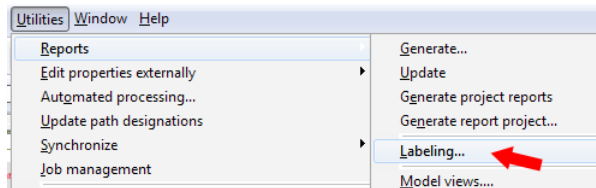


Fig. 6.120 Labeling

### 6.7.1 Settings

This section deals with the basic settings for outputting labeling. When the *Labeling* function is started, EPLAN displays the **OUTPUT LABELING** dialog.

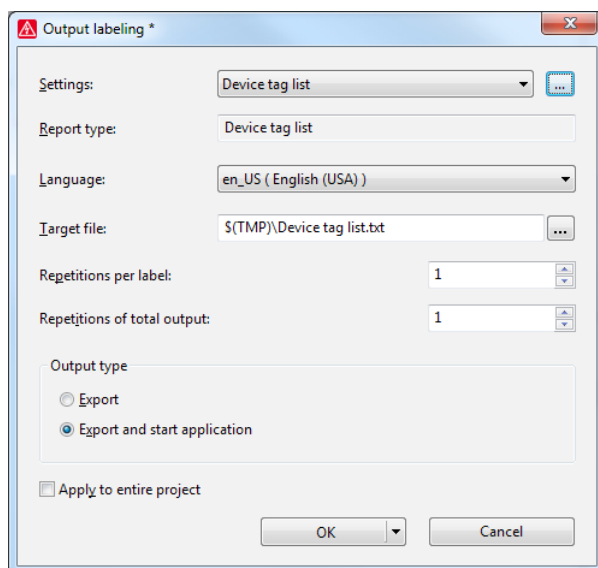


Fig. 6.121 Output labeling

This dialog offers the following settings options:

*Settings:* Here you can select what data is to be output. You can filter and/or sort the output.

*Report type:* This field merely displays which report type is used as the basis of the set labeling scheme.

*Language:* This setting controls the language output of the labeling file. Only the languages set in the project are available here. EPLAN offers two ways of selecting the language: A single language or all project languages at once can be output.

*Target file:* This is where you enter the name of the output file (according to the selected scheme) for the labeling data to be generated.

*Value for repetitions:* All values greater than 1 increase the output of the labeling data by the value specified here. The default value here is 1 (output the data once).

*Output type:* The generated file is exported, or you can cause the exported file to be subsequently opened with a specified editor so that you can check or edit the contents.



**TIP:** The editor to be used is defined by an entry in the user settings. This entry is located under **OPTIONS/SETTINGS/USER/DISPLAY/IDENTIFIER**. You select the **OPTIONS** button in the schemes.

*Apply to entire project:* Regardless of what data is selected, this setting always causes the entire project's data to be written.

6.7.1.1 Preparatory settings

The most important area in the OUTPUT LABELING dialog is the *settings*: What data should be output here and under which relationships? This is defined via predefined schemes or your own schemes.

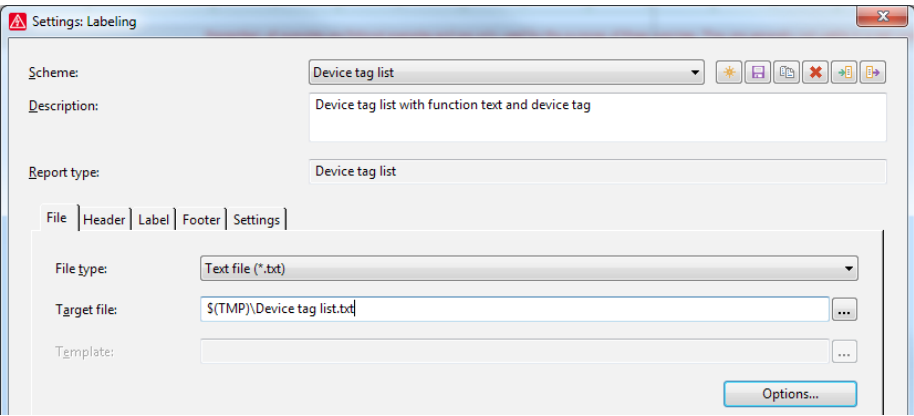


Fig. 6.122 The Labeling dialog with the scheme and the settings

To add a setting, you click the  selection button next to the *Settings* field. The **SETTINGS/LABELING** dialog is displayed. The dialog is basically divided into two areas: the area with information on the scheme itself (name of the scheme, description, and report type), and the lower area with the tabs for various data and settings such as file, header, label, and footer, and other output settings such as filter, sorting, etc.

The file type to be created is important when creating a labeling file. Other settings, such as which program to use for opening the generated file, depend on this value.

EPLAN offers several different file types here.

File types for outputting labeling

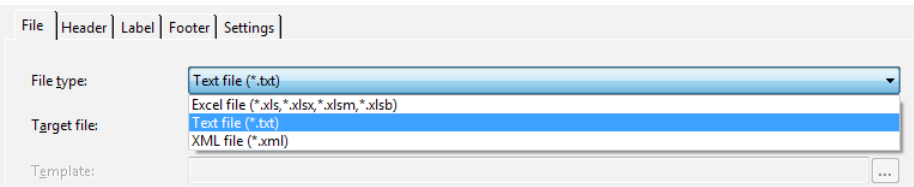


Fig. 6.123 Selection of the file type

*The Excel file \*.xl\*:* Files with this format, as the name indicates, are opened with Excel. Whereas a text file is usually output without formatting, the Excel format can be used, for example, to output cable diagrams formatted in an Excel template. This produces report files that look similar to those generated in the graphical report pages. You can use the **OPTIONS** button to also output column designations.

*The text file \*.txt:* A normal text file is created with this file type. It can be edited with a conventional text editor. The **OPTIONS** button allows further settings to be defined for a

text file. Examples are the ANSI output character set or separators for multi-language output.

*The XML file \*.xml:* The last possible data type generates an XML file that can be opened and edited with an appropriate XML editor. No other options are available for this file type.

When outputting a labeling file, the correct file format should be chosen before generating the output. The *\*.txt* file format is usually the right one for outputting project data such as cable device tags (e.g. for labeling cable shields). In practice, you should always check what data format can be edited by the downstream systems.

Next to the *Scheme* selection field is the toolbar with editing functions for the scheme. You use these buttons to create, edit, and delete schemes, etc.

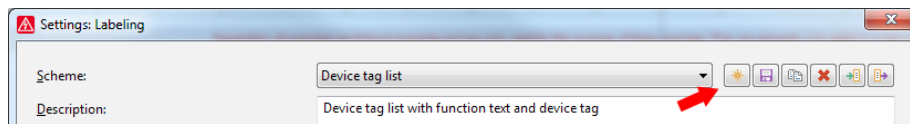


Fig. 6.124 Toolbar for editing the selected scheme

### 6.7.1.2 Labeling as text output

You create a new scheme via the  button. EPLAN first asks for the *report type*. You should enter a suitably descriptive name and description in the subsequent dialog. One advantage of this is that every user has an immediate understanding of the purpose of the scheme. Another advantage is that this scheme name can also be used to export the scheme, eliminating duplicate work later on.

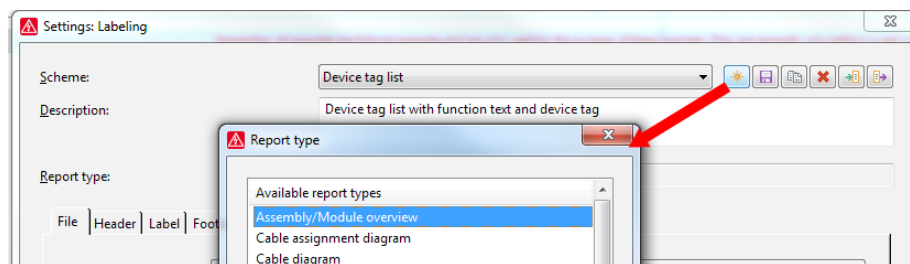


Fig. 6.125 Select report type

Once the header of the scheme has been defined, you can fill the scheme with the required format elements. Format elements in EPLAN represent the *available properties* of the project, pages, and devices. Format elements are thus nothing more than *properties*. The file type is set to *\*.txt*. You can now use the *Header*, *Label* and *Footer* tabs to assign *format elements* to the scheme.

The tabs are all structured in a similar way. To the left is the field with the *available format elements* (the actual properties) and the right area contains the overview of currently selected format elements. You use the  button to “copy” selected elements from the left field to the right field.

 Depending on the property selected, you can open an additional dialog to make a more detailed selection of one of the properties.

You can delete elements from the right field using the  button on the toolbar. You must, of course, first select the element you wish to delete.

 **NOTE:** Clicking the  button immediately removes the element. There are no other confirmation prompts.



To assign a format element to the scheme, you switch to the *Label* tab. EPLAN offers a lot of possible project data (properties) that can be used for labeling.

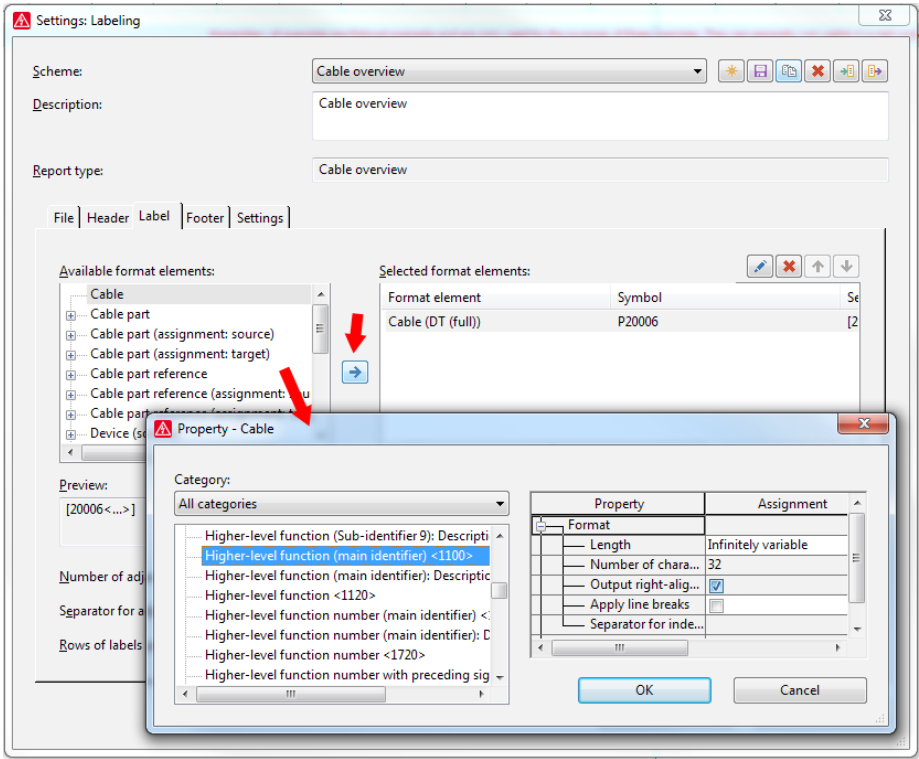


Fig. 6.126 Selecting desired properties

The cable device tag should be output in a cable overview. The cable device tag belongs to the cable properties group, since the DT is a property of a symbol (terminal, cable, etc.). You select the format element in the left field with the left mouse button. You now use the  button to move the *Cable property* format element from the left field (*Available format elements*) to the right field (*Selected format elements*).

EPLAN then opens the **PROPERTY – CABLE** dialog. All available cable properties are listed here.

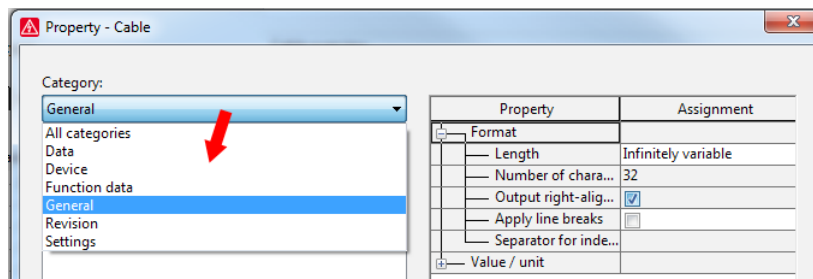


Fig. 6.127 Categories

You can limit this property overview by selecting a more suitable value in the *Category* field, *Devices* for example. This hides all properties that do not belong to this category. This greatly simplifies the overview.

To allow the cable device tag to be output later in the labeling file, the **<20006 DT (full)>** property must be selected from the list and applied by clicking OK.

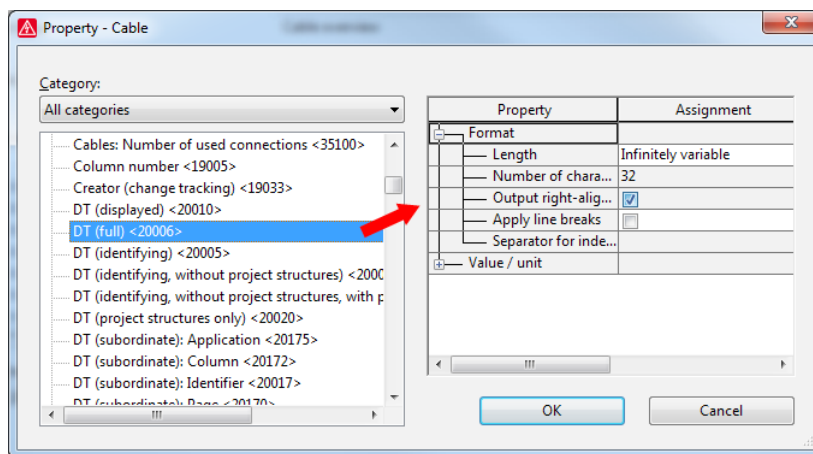


Fig. 6.128 Possible assignments for selected properties

The additional options in the right side of the dialog should be set as needed. This requires no further explanation. After applying the property, EPLAN closes the dialog. Property **<20006>** is now located in the right field with the selected format elements and with the correct settings (unlimited variable length). These entries can be changed at any later time. You use the toolbar above the field to do this. This applies to all available tabs in the Labeling dialog.

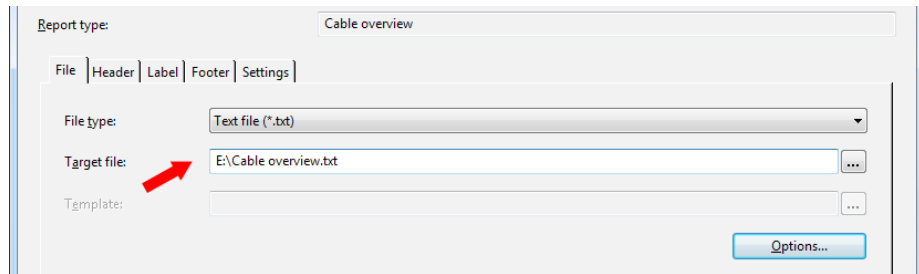


Fig. 6.129 Select target file

Now only the name of the target file is missing. This completes all entries and you can save the scheme by clicking . Click OK to exit the settings dialog. EPLAN returns to the LABELING dialog.

The labeling file can now be generated. You only need to set the desired output type.

If the file is only going to be exported, then the *Export* setting is sufficient. If the file is to be subsequently edited, you should set the *Output type* setting to *Export and start application*.

The result of the example is shown in Fig. 6.130 (opened in a text editor).

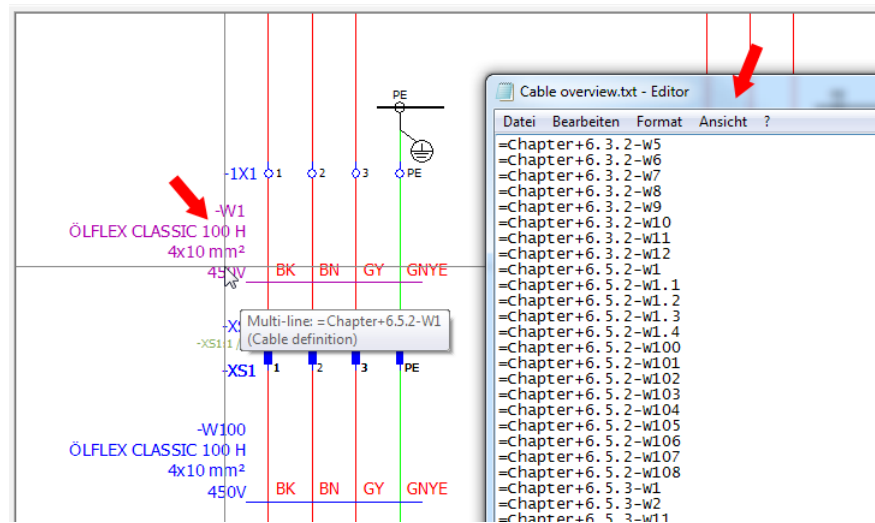


Fig. 6.130 Generated text file with information

### 6.7.1.3 Labeling as Excel file

In addition to text output, EPLAN also allows output in the Excel format *\*.xls*. This allows you to replicate the graphical output in Excel if necessary. The preparatory procedure is similar to that for outputting a text file. This means that you again generate a scheme containing assigned format elements.

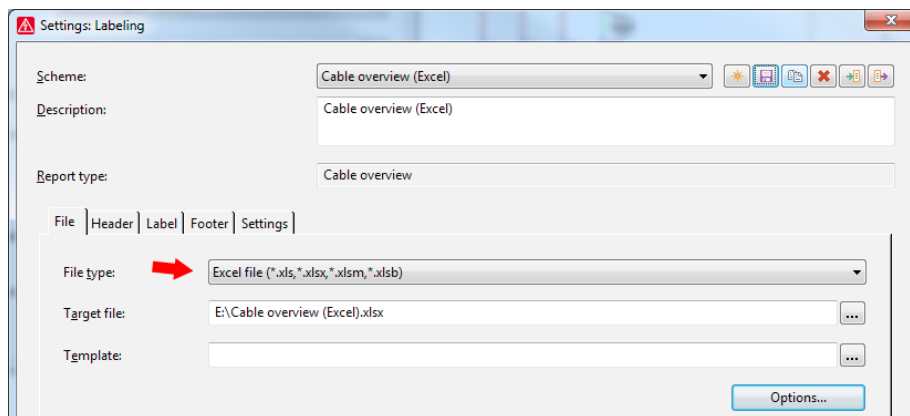


Fig. 6.131 Scheme for output to Excel

However, the following points must be noted when generating Excel files. For an Excel output, a template **can** be stored in the scheme. This template is created in Excel with variables before the data is output and then later assigned to the scheme. EPLAN later writes the project data (as specified in the scheme) into these variables.

The following example is explained **without** an Excel template, since an Excel template is not absolutely necessary.



**NOTE:** You *can*, but you don't *have* to use an Excel template.

You move the data from the pool of available properties to the list of *selected format elements* in the usual way.

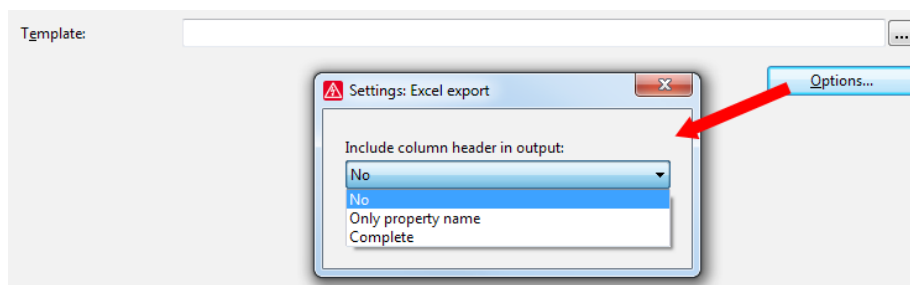


Fig. 6.132 Options button

The **OPTIONS** button on the *File* tab is important when outputting to Excel. EPLAN offers three settings here to *include column header in output*.



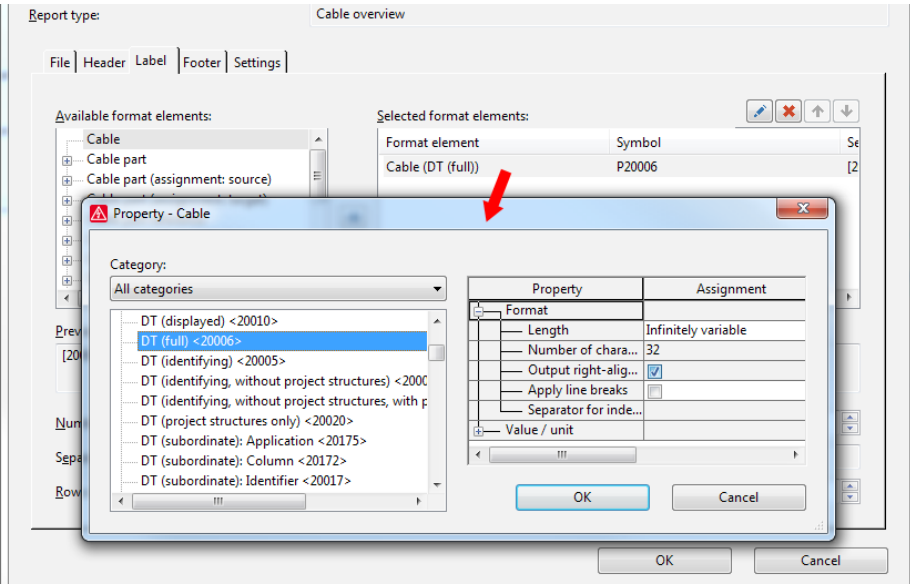


Fig. 6.133 Example of properties for column labeling

*No:* No output of column designation, and thus no output of column header.

*Only property name:* Only the property name is output (e. g. (full) DT).

*Full:* The full string (property name including other data) is generated as column headers (e. g. cable/(full) DT).

Once these two things have been done and the data has been correctly stored in the scheme and the scheme has been saved, EPLAN can start the output of project data in the Excel format. As you already know, this is done via the UTILITIES/REPORTS/LABELING menu item. The OUTPUT LABELING dialog then opens. Here you select the desired scheme and set the corresponding output type. You now confirm the output by clicking OK. EPLAN generates the data and saves it in the Excel format. When you open the Excel file you can see, as in our example, the transferred cable overview with all the data that was previously assigned to the scheme.

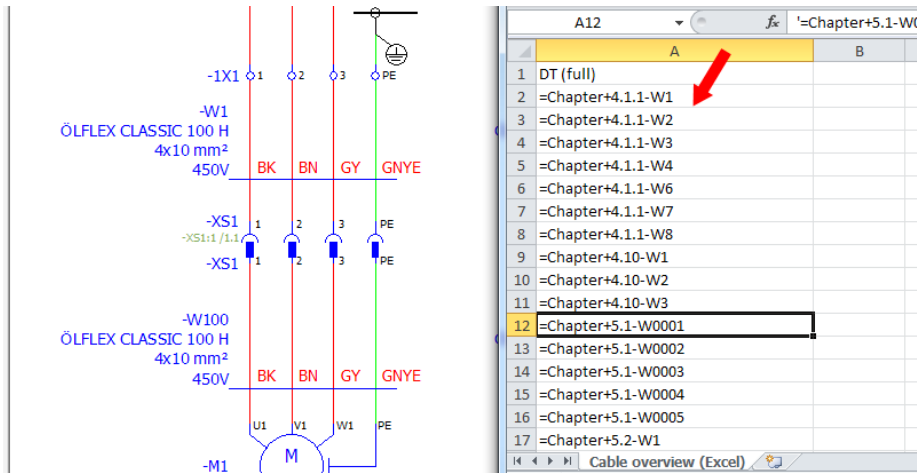


Fig. 6.134 Generated Excel file with the data from EPLAN

## 6.8 Edit properties externally

In addition to generating reports in the form of graphical output pages or files, EPLAN provides another powerful tool with the *Edit properties externally* function.

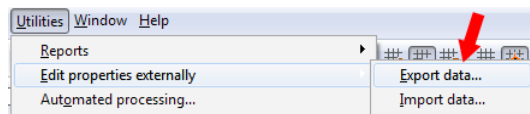


Fig. 6.135 Edit properties externally menu



**NOTE:** One important thing should always be noted: Whatever you wish to externally edit must always first be highlighted (selected) in EPLAN.

If you wish to edit page properties then you must select the desired pages or select the entire project (project name) in the page navigator. This also selects all pages. If you wish to edit only particular terminals (functions) on a page then you must select precisely these terminals.

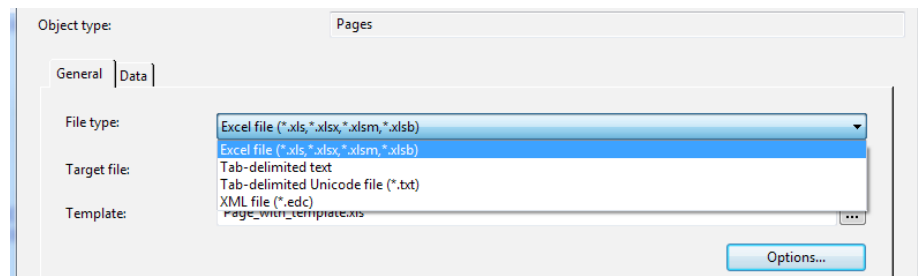
These functions can be described very simply. They allow project data to be transferred to Excel, edited there, and then transferred back to EPLAN.



**NOTE:** At the moment, Excel is the only program available for external editing.

The data, which is easy to rename, exchange or enhance in Excel, is then synchronized with the existing project data. This avoids subsequent editing in EPLAN; this is a very powerful function.

However, we should explicitly mention here that there is no UNDO function after transferring the data back. Once the data has been synchronized with the schematic, there is no way back. You should therefore always be very careful when using this powerful function. If you are not sure, then you should work with a copy of the current project. Here you can check the results and adjust the settings for the external properties as necessary.



**Fig. 6.136** File types for external editing

Using Excel is, of course, not the only way of doing this. EPLAN offers a number of other file types for output that are listed below:

- Excel file formats (\*.xl\*)
- Tab-delimited Unicode file (\*.txt)
- Tab-delimited text
- XML file (\*.edc)

However, the following examples will only deal with output to Excel. Exporting of page data will be used to illustrate the creation of a scheme, the export to Excel, and the import into EPLAN.

The other possibilities of exporting functions or connections are performed in an identical manner. The only differences are usually just the data and/or the property values.

### 6.8.1 Export data

EPLAN allows for the transferring of project data to Excel. This relates to the following project data (extract):



**NOTE:** Generally, most properties are suitable for export. But not all properties can also be edited externally. This should be kept in mind.

**Pages:** For example, all data related to pages, such as page names, page supplementary fields and other properties assigned to a page (such as a form)

**Functions:** Functions are device tags, cable comments, connection point designations, and everything relating to devices, symbols, or the associated parts. The range of possible data is, of course, much larger, but this is sufficient as an example.

**Connections:** All data related to connections

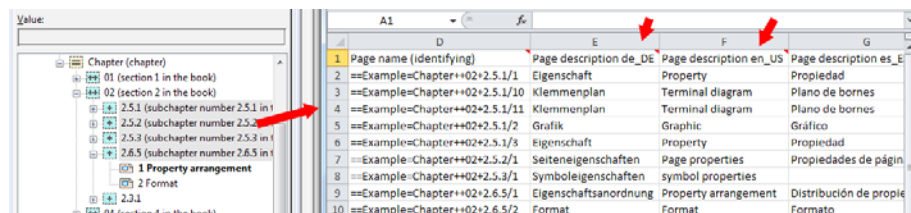
This is because EPLAN needs certain important information in order to write back the modified data at the correct position in the schematic. If this data basis is denied to EPLAN, then it has no idea where the data should be placed and may end up generating incorrect data.

Some properties are locked for editing to prevent this problem. You can still change these externally, but EPLAN simply ignores these changes when reading back the data tables.

### 6.8.1.1 Settings – sample pages

EPLAN allows a large amount of data for pages and their descriptions. Most of this data can be conveniently edited in the page navigator (page overview). This is even easier when you create an export to Excel for the pages and their properties. You can then use many Excel functions that do not exist, or are very difficult to implement, in EPLAN. To use this feature, you must first create a scheme in EPLAN with the associated properties. An Excel template is also useful, but not absolutely necessary.

Without an Excel template, for example, you get the result shown in Fig. 6.137.



|    | D                              | E                      | F                      | G                      |
|----|--------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|
| 1  | Page name (identifying)        | Page description de_DE | Page description en_US | Page description es_E  |
| 2  | ==Example=Chapter++02+2.5.1/1  | Eigenschaft            | Property               | Propiedad              |
| 3  | ==Example=Chapter++02+2.5.1/10 | Klemmenplan            | Terminal diagram       | Plano de bornes        |
| 4  | ==Example=Chapter++02+2.5.1/11 | Klemmenplan            | Terminal diagram       | Plano de bornes        |
| 5  | ==Example=Chapter++02+2.5.1/2  | Grafik                 | Graphic                | Gráfico                |
| 6  | ==Example=Chapter++02+2.5.1/3  | Eigenschaft            | Property               | Propiedad              |
| 7  | ==Example=Chapter++02+2.5.2/1  | Seiteneigenschaften    | Page properties        | Propiedades de página  |
| 8  | ==Example=Chapter++02+2.5.3/1  | Symboleigenschaften    | symbol properties      |                        |
| 9  | ==Example=Chapter++02+2.6.5/1  | Eigenschaftsanordnung  | Property arrangement   | Distribución de prople |
| 10 | ==Example=Chapter++02+2.6.5/2  | Format                 | Format                 | Formato                |

Fig. 6.137 Exported data without Excel template

The problem with this representation is that all cells look the same here and can also be edited. However, as already mentioned, not all edited values are re-imported into EPLAN. To make it clear that this is not caused by errors in the program but rather errors in the application, it is a good idea to use a formatted Excel template. A formatted Excel template provides an overview of which properties have changed and which properties are not able to be written back to EPLAN for programming reasons.

An example of a formatted Excel template is shown in Fig. 6.138.

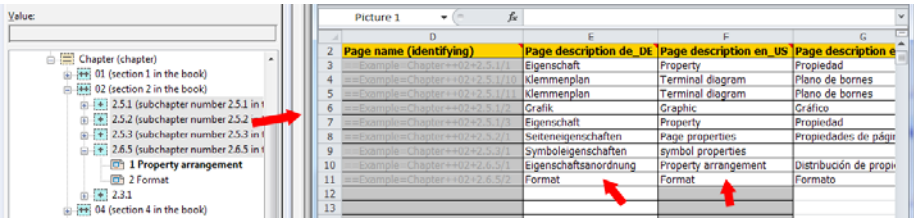


Fig. 6.138 Exported data with Excel template

The easiest way to create a template is to modify one of the templates provided in the EPLAN master data. You use the usual Excel editing functions for this.

The following points are important for the template: There is a *header* and a *data area*. The header area is marked with the **#H#** identifier and the data area with the **###** identifier. The number of properties transferred by EPLAN is irrelevant for these templates. The rest of the template can be structured in any desired manner.

To allow EPLAN and Excel to select the different areas (which properties are editable or not), the Excel template has a second *Format* worksheet.

This worksheet has several entries. These entries should not be deleted, nor should the text be modified. However, the format of the cells (background color, font, text size, etc.) can be changed to suit your needs. Changing the cell format affects the later visual appearance of the worksheet.

For the sake of completeness, the meanings of these entries are listed here.

- **#H#**: Header area (headers)
- **#HD#**: Automatically added header data
- **#F#**: Footer
- **###**: Data area
- **#ID#**: Identifier for a property
- **#RO#**: Property has the read-only format and cannot be changed; EPLAN ignores these values when reading back the data.
- **#RW#**: Property has the read-write format and the values can be changed as desired. However, illogical values are not adopted by EPLAN.

Fig. 6.139  
Worksheet table 1

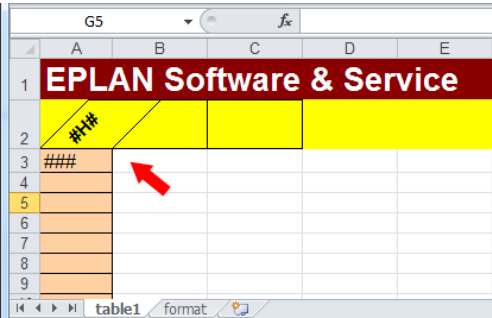
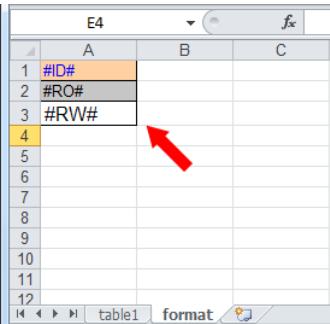


Fig. 6.140  
The Format worksheet



The Excel template is now complete. You now save this in any desired directory. The ideal location would be the EPLAN *Templates* directory. We still don't have the EPLAN scheme allowing the properties to be transferred to Excel.

To create this scheme, you use the **UTILITIES/EDIT PROPERTIES EXTERNALLY/EXPORT DATA** dialog. EPLAN opens the **EDIT EXTERNALLY** dialog with the scheme most recently used.

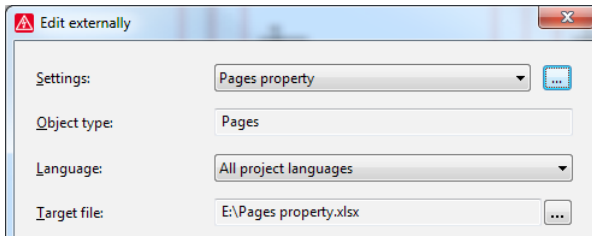


Fig. 6.141 Edit externally dialog

Use the More button to open the **SETTINGS/EXTERNAL EDITING** dialog.

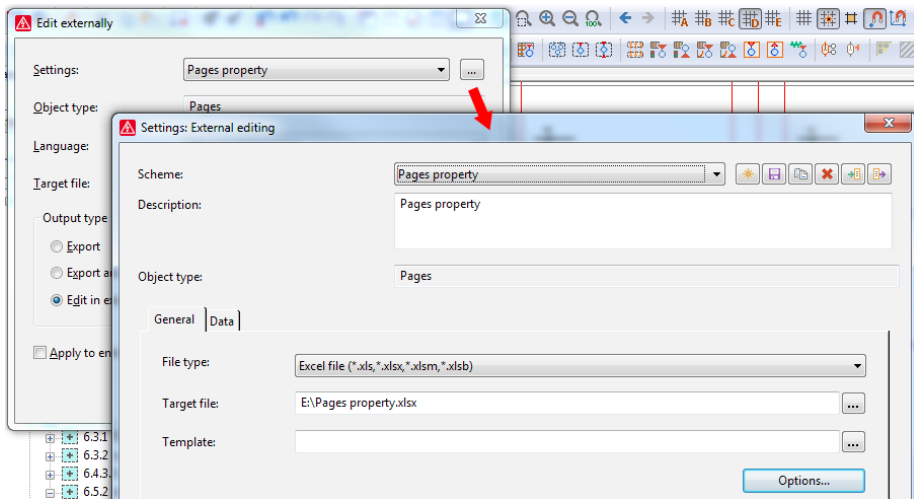


Fig. 6.142 Settings External editing dialog

Click the button to create a new scheme. This opens the **OBJECT TYPE** dialog. The desired type (e.g. pages) is selected and applied by clicking OK.

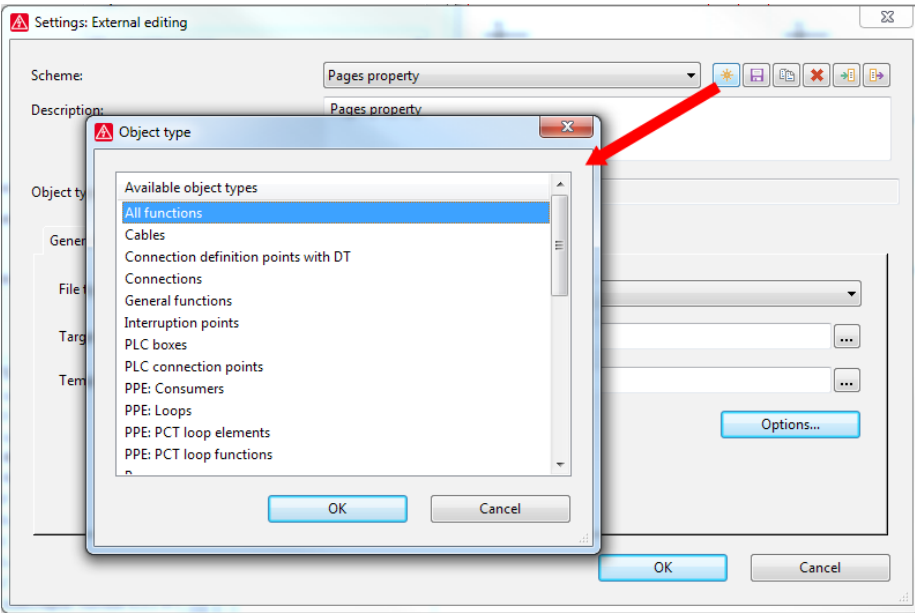


Fig. 6.143 Object type dialog

The NEW SCHEME dialog opens.

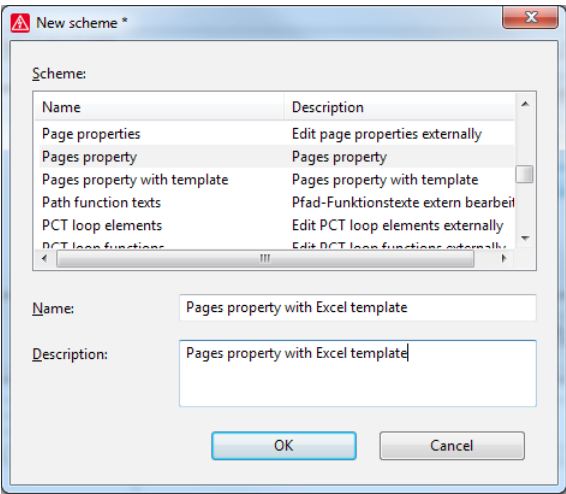


Fig. 6.144 New scheme dialog

Here you enter a descriptive name and a description for the scheme and apply these settings by clicking OK. You can now fill the new scheme with the desired values.

Settings for transferring data to Excel

In the *File type* selection field, you select the Excel file (\*.xlsx) value. You can enter any value into the *Target file* field. The *Template* field is important. Here, you should select the

Excel template that you just created for the scheme. This completes the entries in the *General* tab.

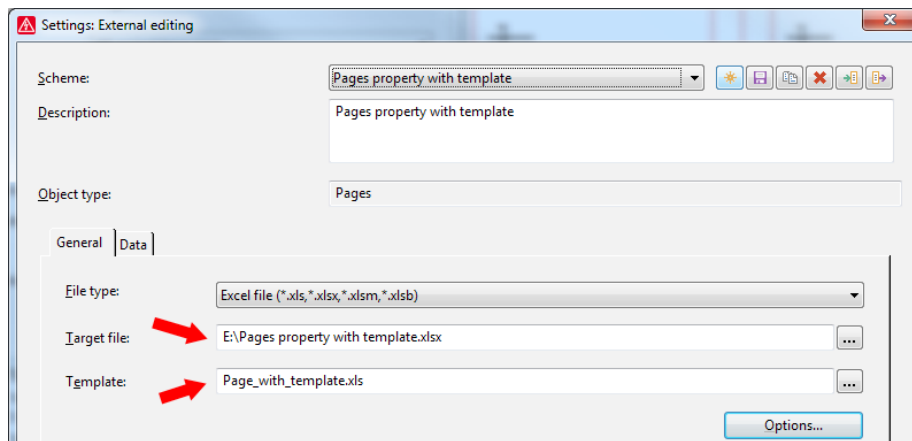


Fig. 6.145 Settings in the General tab

To transfer the properties to Excel, you must now select the desired properties in the *Data* tab. This is done in a similar way to selecting properties for labeling data. As you can see in Fig. 6.146 for this example, a number of properties have been added to the *Selected format elements* field.

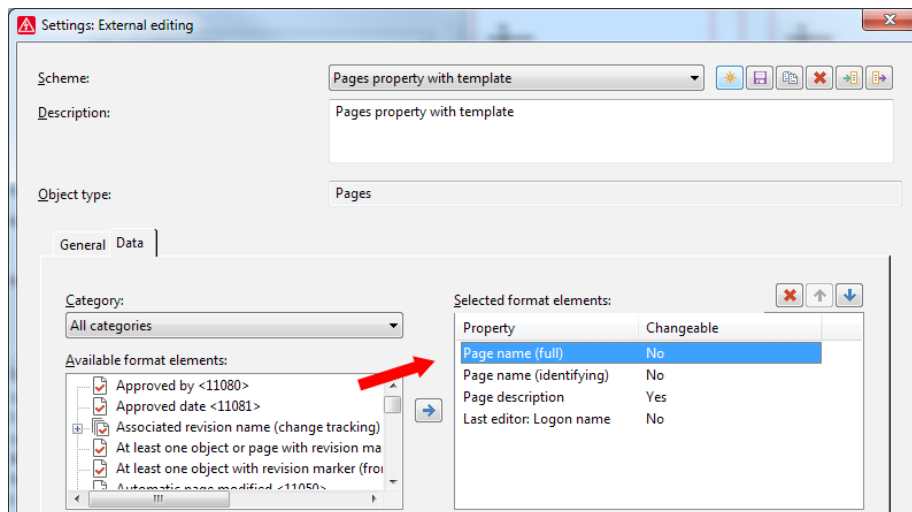


Fig. 6.146 Settings in the Data tab

This completes all of the required steps. The scheme is now saved, and the dialog can be confirmed by clicking OK.



### 6.8.1.2 Export data – sample pages

To be able to export page properties of a project with this scheme so that you can externally edit them, you call up the **page navigator** and select the desired project with the left mouse button or individually select the desired pages in the page navigator.

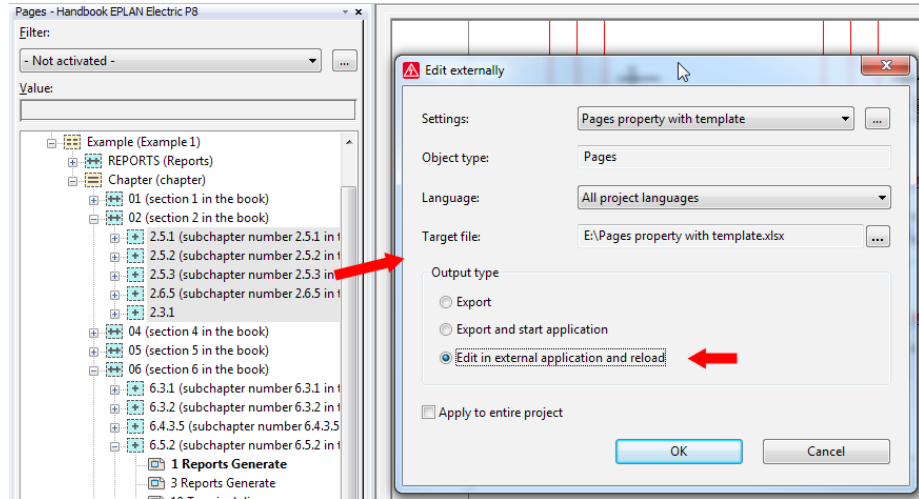


Fig. 6.147 Selected pages

Then, use the **UTILITIES/EDIT PROPERTIES EXTERNALLY/EXPORT DATA** menu to select and/or call the desired scheme. Select the desired option in the *Language* selection field and then select either a single language or all of the languages set in the project.

The *Output type* options are the most important point for outputting the data.

The *Export* output type generates the data and creates the output file, but does not open it.

The **Export and start application** option generates the output file, and then opens this in the specified application (in this case Excel), where you can then edit and save the output file. This does not update any data in EPLAN. The saved output file can later be read back into the EPLAN project via **UTILITIES/EDIT PROPERTIES EXTERNALLY/IMPORT DATA**. This option is useful when the data is to be further edited, e.g. by a customer.

The last option, **Edit in external application and reload**, includes a transfer of the data from EPLAN to Excel. It can now be edited there. After editing, the file can be saved and Excel can be exited. This is followed by a confirmation prompt asking if the data really should be imported. If you confirm the dialog by clicking YES, then EPLAN synchronizes the data from the Excel file with the project data.

To export the data, edit it in Excel, and then re-synchronize it with the EPLAN project, you should select the last output type. The target file (where the data should be written to) is specified in the scheme.

Clicking the OK button generates the output file and then starts Excel. The loaded data can now be edited or changed.

After making all your changes, you save the Excel file (click the  button once or press CTRL + S) and can now close Excel.

This is followed by a confirmation prompt asking if you really want to import the changed data. When you confirm this dialog by clicking YES, then all modified data is written back to the project and is now available there.

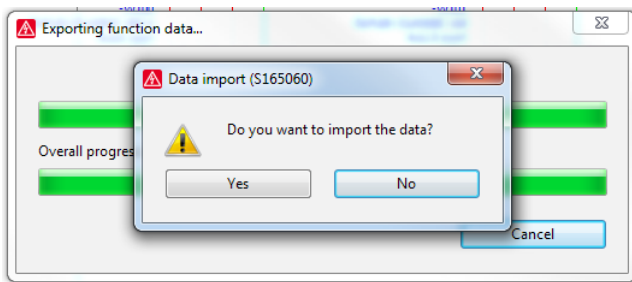


Fig. 6.148 Data import dialog



**NOTE:** It is not possible to undo this action (importing changed data).

## 6.8.2 Import data

Up to now, we have exported data, edited the data externally, and then written it back to the EPLAN project. Immediately writing back the data may sometimes not be desired.

In this case, in the **EDIT DATA EXTERNALLY** dialog, you should set the output type to *Export* or *Export and start application*. This then only transfers the data to Excel and either immediately stores it in the target file, or writes it to the application where it can then be edited further and subsequently saved.

You can also exit project editing in the aforementioned cases. The exported data can now be edited as desired, and then read back into the project at a later time.

This will be explained with an example: In this example, cable function texts will be entered and changed. You either select all cables in the cable navigator (by selecting the project) or select only the required cables on a page.

Using a scheme that contains the properties you want to change, you export the functions and save them to an Excel file. This file can now be edited by an employee who might not have EPLAN Electric P8 installed.

The cable function texts can now be entered or modified in the Excel file, and the saved Excel file can now be read back (imported) into EPLAN.

Open the UTILITIES/EDIT PROPERTIES EXTERNALLY/IMPORT DATA menu item and select the Excel file to be imported. The OPEN dialog is displayed. Here, you use the normal Windows functions to select and open the file using the OPEN button. EPLAN now imports the file **immediately and without any other prompts** and writes the modified data back to the project. This completes the import.



**NOTE:** No confirmation prompt is displayed at this point. EPLAN imports this data into the project immediately after the file is opened. There is no UNDO function at this point.

# 7

## Management tasks in EPLAN

A lot of different types of data must be managed in EPLAN. EPLAN has functions that can handle these various, and sometimes different, tasks. This chapter will explain some of these functions.

In EPLAN, you not only need to manage all types of structure identifiers, but also project messages that occur either online while editing projects, or offline as a result of error checking. You need to organize and manage parts data and the various layers of a project as well. This is why I use the general term “Management”.

### ■ 7.1 Structure identifier management



Fig. 7.1 Structure identifier management

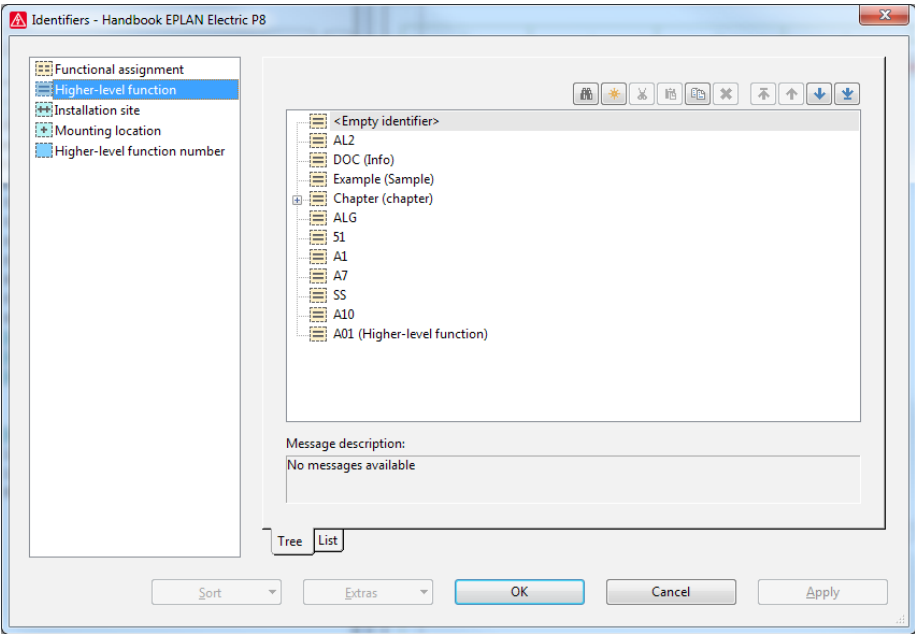
As soon as a project has a page structure other than **Sequential numbering**, the different structure identifiers in the project will eventually be used somewhere.



Every possible identifier block in a project is assigned a specific identifier that can consist of a string of letters and/or numbers. These identifiers are known as structure identifiers.

Structure identifier management is called up via **PROJECT DATA/STRUCTURE IDENTIFIER MANAGEMENT** menu item. EPLAN opens the **IDENTIFIERS – [PROJECT NAME]** dialog.

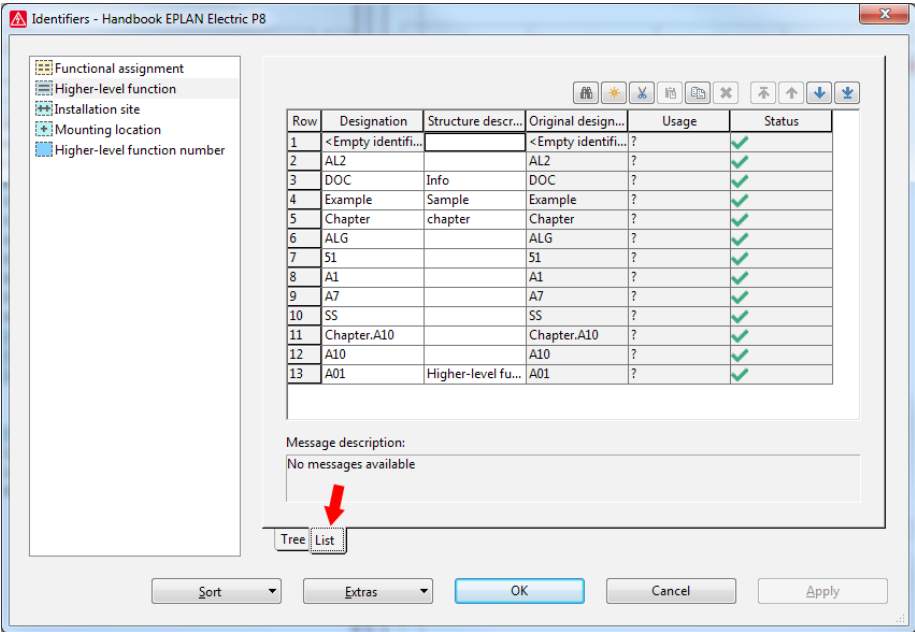
**Fig. 7.2**  
Control center of  
structure identifier  
management  
(tree view)



The dialog consists essentially of two familiar views: the tree and list views. The following sections will focus primarily on the list view.

The tree view provides an easy and ‘quick’ overview of the identifiers entered, while the list view offers more options.

**Fig. 7.3**  
Identifiers dialog in the  
list view



The possible structure identifiers of a project such as **higher-level function**, **installation site** or **mounting location** are managed centrally in EPLAN. The sequence of these structure identifiers and the sequence of the pages in a project are closely related. The page structure is sorted in the page navigator in the same way as the structure identifiers. Several mounting locations are entered in structure identifier management (not all mounting locations need to have been used previously in the page structure).



| Row | Designation | Structure description               | Original designat... | Usage |
|-----|-------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------|-------|
| 8   | Name        | Name                                | Name                 | ?     |
| 9   | 1           | main chapter 1                      | 1                    | ?     |
| 10  | 1.2         | subchapter number 1.2 in the book   | 1.2                  | ?     |
| 11  | 2           | main chapter 2                      | 2                    | ?     |
| 12  | 2.5         | subchapter number 2.5 in the book   | 2.5                  | ?     |
| 13  | 2.5.1       | subchapter number 2.5.1 in the b... | 2.5.1                | ?     |
| 14  | 2.5.2       | subchapter number 2.5.2 in the b... | 2.5.2                | ?     |

Fig. 7.4 Sequence of the mounting location

The page structure in the page navigator is now sorted according to the defaults in structure identifier management (Fig. 7.5).

For example, if you want to sort mounting location ++EO1 after mounting location ++8.6.1 in the page structure, you change this sequence in structure identifier management.

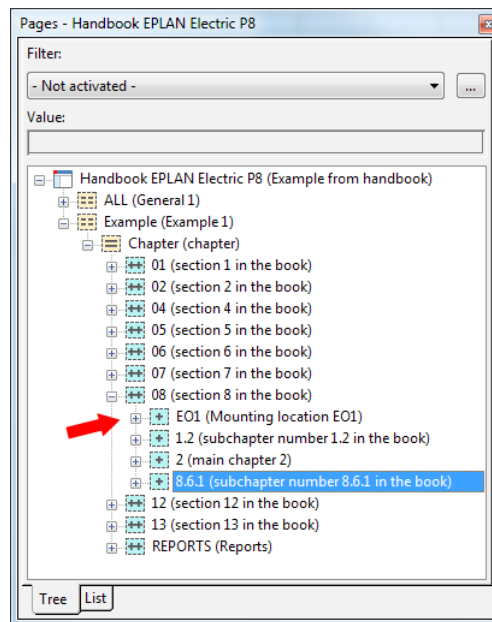
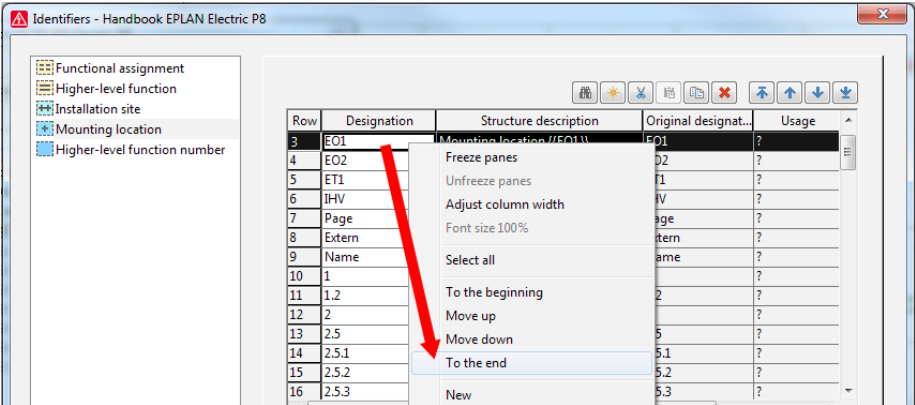


Fig. 7.5  
Sequence in the  
page navigator

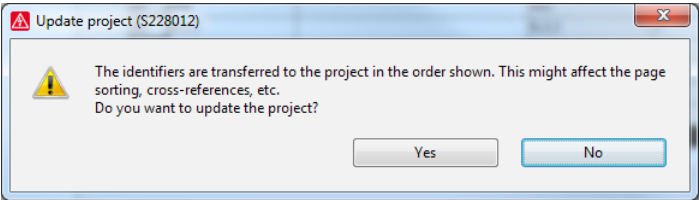
Fig. 7.6  
Changing the  
sequence of structure  
identifiers



This is done, for example, by selecting the row and then calling the popup menu via the right mouse button. Here, you will see functions such as *To the beginning* (will be moved there) or *Down* (will be moved down by a row) and many others.

Once sorting has taken place and after you click the **OK** button at the bottom of the dialog, EPLAN will ask whether the changes should be applied.

Fig. 7.7  
Apply project data  
changes dialog

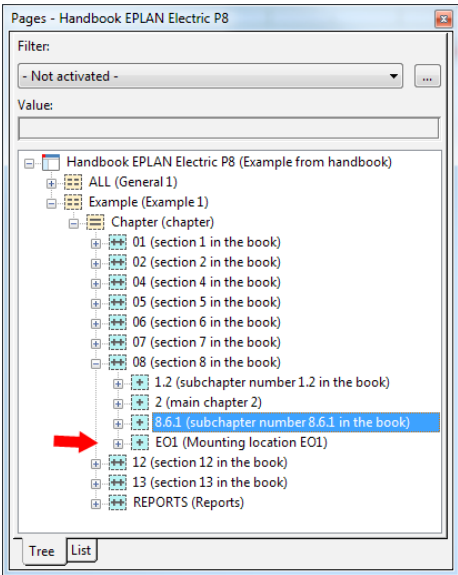


When you confirm, the changes are applied and the page structure is adjusted in the page navigator.

This is only one of many functions in structure identifier management. Among other features, it is also possible to copy structure identifiers from an Excel table into structure identifier management. This eliminates the time-consuming process of manually entering the data into EPLAN.

Up to three detailed descriptions can be entered for each structure identifier. As a result, reports or graphical generation of structure identifier overviews can be filled with this information and the data need not be entered manually. The graphical output and the information contained therein depend, of course, on the structure of the forms used.

Fig. 7.8  
Changed sequence



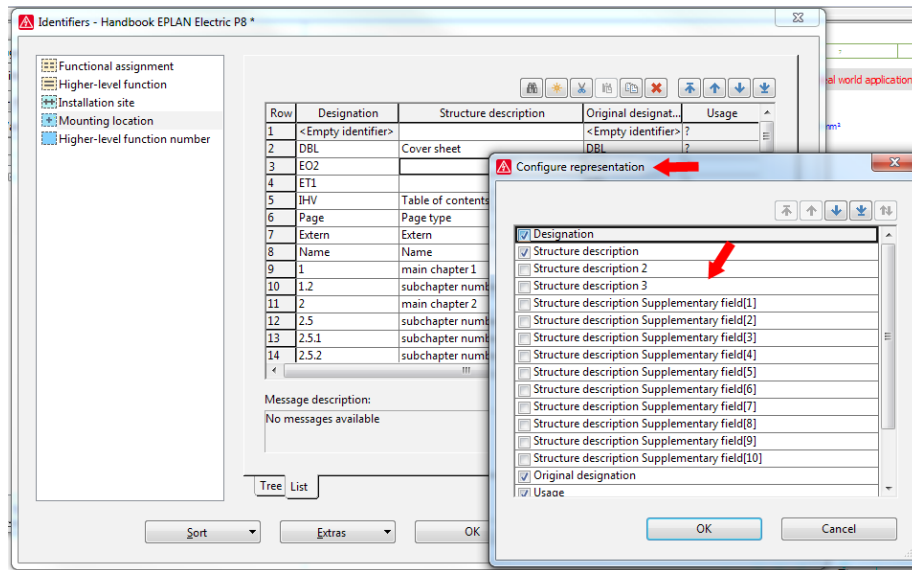


Fig. 7.9 Further descriptive options (properties)

### 7.1.1 List of identifiers in structure identifier management

The list of identifiers (left side in the **IDENTIFIERS** dialog) corresponds to the page structure entered, which was selected when the project was created.



**NOTE:** The list of identifiers has the same structure and is used in the same way. Therefore only one identifier in the list and its functions will be explained.

EPLAN can manage up to seven structure identifiers in one project, the so-called identifier blocks. The following structure identifiers are possible:

- **Functional assignment:** Superior to the **higher-level function** identifier block. The following prefixes are possible for the functional assignment in EPLAN: “==”, “#” or “≠”
- **Higher-level function:** The **higher-level function** identifier block is used, for example, for the identifiers of system parts. A possible prefix in EPLAN is “=”.
- **Installation site:** The **installation site** identifier describes the physical site of devices or system parts. EPLAN uses “++” as the identifier.

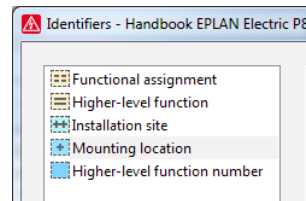


Fig. 7.10  
List of identifiers in  
structure identifier management



- **Mounting location:** The mounting location describes the place where devices are mounted/installed. For example, pushbuttons would have 'control panel' as a mounting location. EPLAN allows "+" as a prefix for this.
- **Higher-level function number:** The higher-level function number is another structuring of devices that is used, for example for fluid devices. The prefix can usually be freely chosen, but should be compatible with the other identifier blocks.
- **Document type:** The document type is an identifier block for the so-called KKS (power station identifier system). EPLAN allows a prefix of "&". A space character can also be used for this.
- **User-defined:** This identifier block can be freely chosen. Any character can be used as the prefix. However, the prefix used should, of course, not conflict with the existing identifiers.

Any number of identifiers can be entered into an **Identifier block**. New identifiers are (or can be, depending on the setting) sorted into structure identifier management, either at the end or alphabetically (depending on the setting).

Which type of sorting is used during editing is defined in a user-specific setting. This setting is accessible via **OPTIONS/SETTINGS/USER/DISPLAY/IDENTIFIER**.

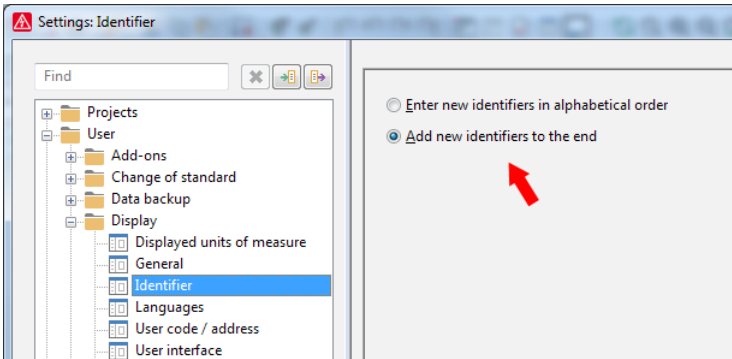


Fig. 7.11 Settings for Place identifiers

In order to assign **Descriptions** to these automatically sorted identifiers, structure identifier management must be started and the descriptions entered later.

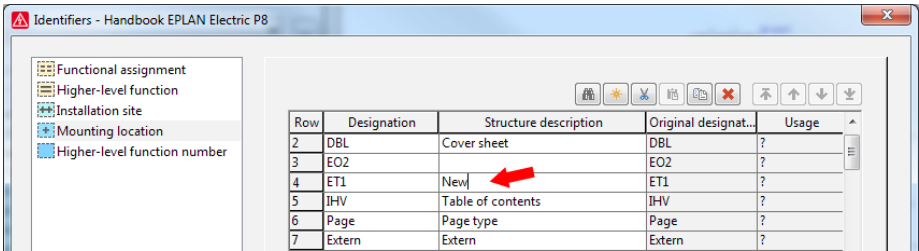


Fig. 7.12 Entering structure designations

EPLAN allows you to manage several structure designations per identifier. These can be structure designations 1 to 3 or the structure designation supplementary fields 1 to 10. These are activated by right clicking to call up the popup menu and then selecting **CONFIGURE REPRESENTATION**. EPLAN then opens the **CONFIGURE REPRESENTATION** dialog. In this dialog, you can select or deselect the appropriate properties for display.

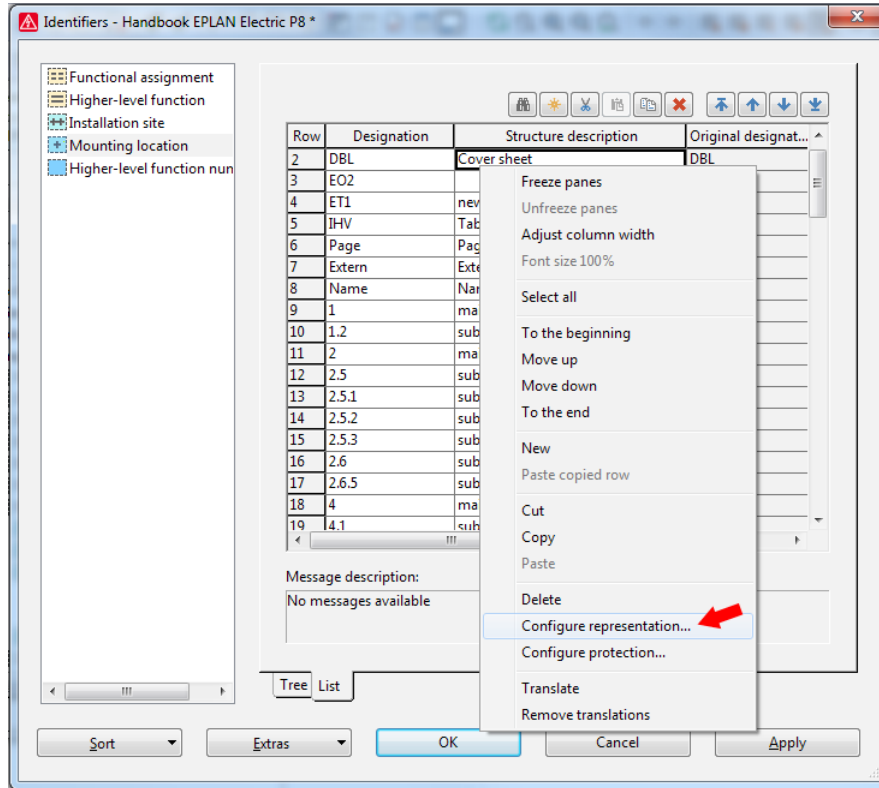


Fig. 7.13 Identifiers – Configure representation dialog

## 7.1.2 Graphical buttons

When working on a project, it is not always possible to ensure that only desired identifiers are entered into the identifier structure. Various types of copy and macro actions usually create unwanted entries in structure identifier management.

For this situation, EPLAN allows convenient subsequent editing of the structure identifiers via functions such as Move or Delete in the graphical toolbar . These (and more) functions are also available via the right-click popup menu. The graphical buttons have the following functions:

-  Opens the **REPLACE** dialog. Allows the user to perform extensive find and replace actions. This usually replaces the manual editing of identifiers.
-  Inserts a new row before the currently selected row
-  Cuts the selected cell(s) and allows this (these) selected cell(s) to be inserted at a different place in the **IDENTIFIERS** dialog
-  The *Insert* function inserts copied (or cut) rows at the specified location.
-  Copies selected rows to the clipboard
-  Deletes selected rows
-  Moves the selected row to the beginning
-  Moves the selected row one position upwards
-  Moves the selected row one position downwards
-  Moves the selected row to the end

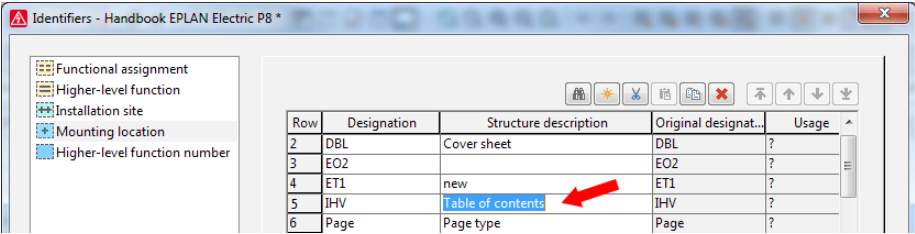


Fig. 7.14 Direct editing using F2

To edit an identifier, you click the corresponding field and can then edit the entry. Or you can press the F2 key to edit entries directly.

Either option opens up different right-click popup menus. But in either popup menu you can use similar functions, such as *Copy*, *Delete* or *Translate*.

Single selection

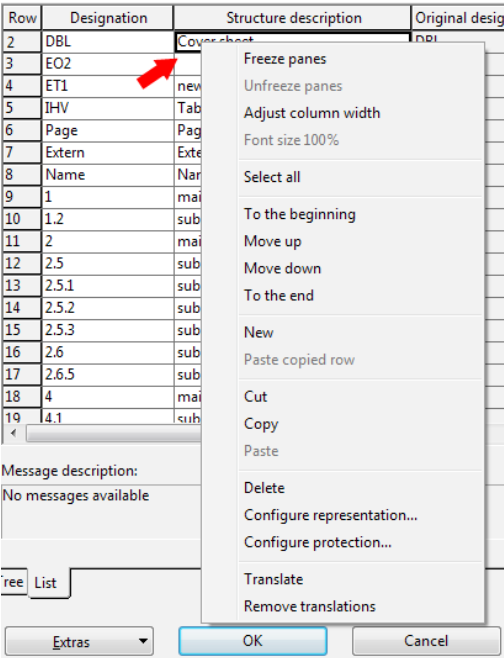


Fig. 7.15 Cell selected

Direct selection

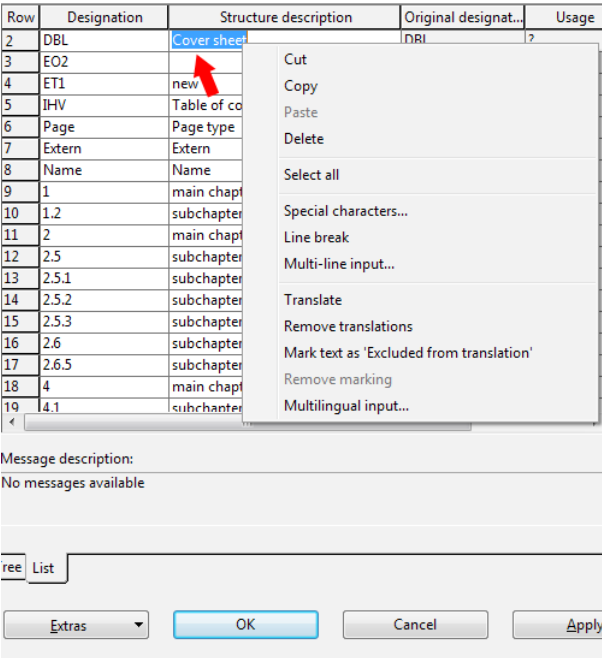


Fig. 7.16 Cell selected with F2

To translate column entries, for example, you first select the entries you want to translate and then use the **CTRL + L** shortcut key or the right-click popup menu to translate them. If EPLAN finds multiple matching entries in the dictionary, it displays the **FOUND WORDS** dialog. You can then select the most suitable entry and apply it by clicking **OK**.



### 7.1.3 Sort menu

The **SORT** menu provides a few automated sorting options for identifiers. Regardless of the sorting used, it is initially a temporary sorting and will not be applied until the **IDENTIFIERS** dialog is closed by clicking **OK** or **APPLY**.

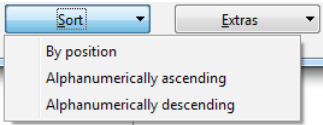


Fig. 7.17  
Sort button

Using the **SORT** menu and the **BY POSITION** option, EPLAN sorts the identifiers according to the internal item numbers. The **Alphanumerically ascending** option sorts the identifiers according to their character strings (numbers take precedence over letters). The **Alphanumerically descending** option sorts the identifiers in descending order.

The identifiers do not generally need to be selected in order to arrange them using the **Sort** option. The cursor must only be in a field. Note that when the identifiers are automatically sorted, the sorting of the page structure follows that of the identifiers.

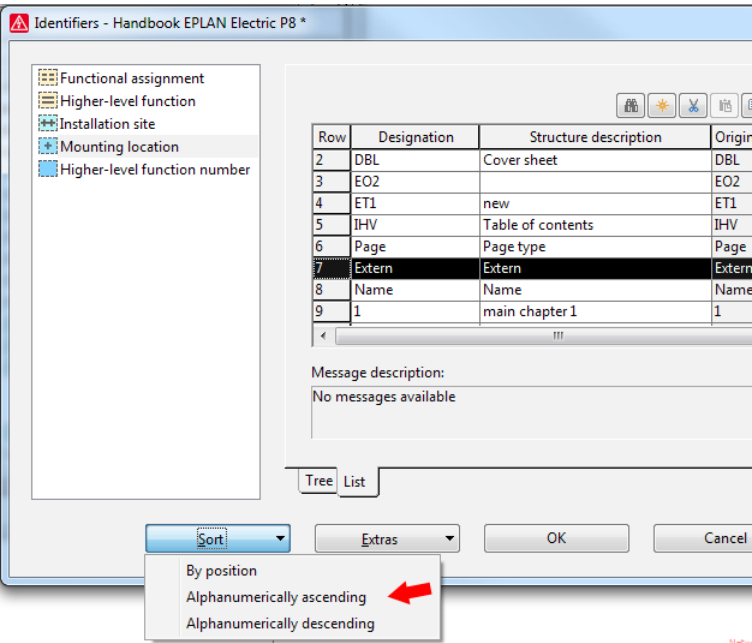


Fig. 7.18 Cursor position

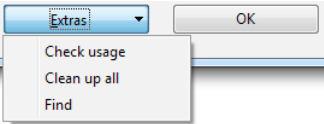
**NOTE:** A new sorting always applies to all identifier types collectively. It is not possible to sort individual identifiers automatically.

7.1.4 Extras menu

The **EXTRAS** button displays an additional menu. This menu contains options allowing unnecessary entries to be cleaned from the database and contains a *Find* function for searching the database.

The **Check usage** option works as follows: When this function is executed, EPLAN checks all identifiers to see if they are used and exist in the project or if they are only entries in the identifier database. These can be entries, for example, that were created from previous copy operations and which can now be deleted. EPLAN designates such identifiers that are no longer used with a **No** in the **Usage** column. These identifiers can be safely removed – even

Fig. 7.19  
Extras button



individually, by selecting the row to be removed – from the database using the graphical [DELETE] button.

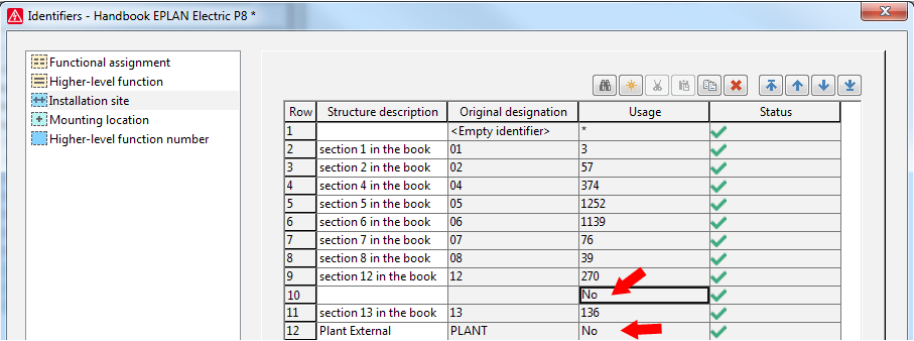


Fig. 7.20  
Check usage

The **Clean up all** option automatically removes all entries from the database that are no longer required, without further prompting.

**NOTE:** Once this function is started, no additional prompts are displayed. The entries are immediately checked for usage, and all unnecessary identifiers are immediately removed.

Since the system does not “know”, for example, when identifiers for higher-level functions or mounting locations have been inserted for later use, these identifiers are also removed. You should therefore be careful when using this function. When you click the OK button, these additional (unused) entries are permanently removed from the database.

The **Find** option displays the **REPLACE** dialog. You can use this to locate entries in the database and replace them with other strings. Find and replace allow for a simple way of replacing terms (or partial terms) with other terms. Here too you should work carefully because no UNDO function is available. Replaced really means replaced!

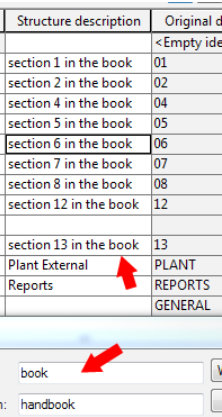


Fig. 7.21 Before replacement

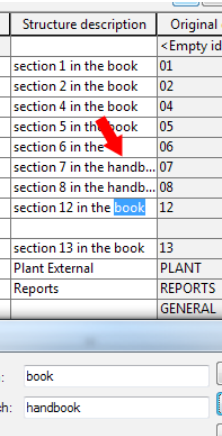


Fig. 7.22 After replacement



**NOTE:** An unwanted replace action can only be undone by exiting the **IDENTIFIERS** dialog with the **CANCEL** button.

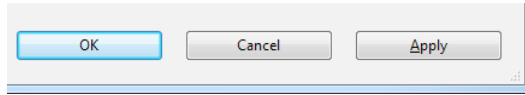


Fig. 7.23 More buttons

In addition to the previously described **SORT** and **EXTRAS** buttons, the dialog also has the **OK**, **CANCEL** and **APPLY** buttons.

You use the **OK** button to exit the **IDENTIFIERS** dialog and, depending on the actions you have performed, you may need to confirm your changes in a subsequent dialog.

Since identifier editing has no **UNDO** function, unlike other features in EPLAN, the **CANCEL** button is very important, because it allows you to discard all changes made.

The **APPLY** button applies (saves) the changes made in structure identifier management without closing the **IDENTIFIERS** dialog. When performing comprehensive actions such as renaming or deleting of unnecessary identifiers, you should first save the contents of the **IDENTIFIERS** dialog via the **APPLY** button before performing the replacement action. If something goes wrong with the replacement action, you can click **CANCEL** to exit the Identifiers dialog. The status will then be exactly the same as before the replacement action started.

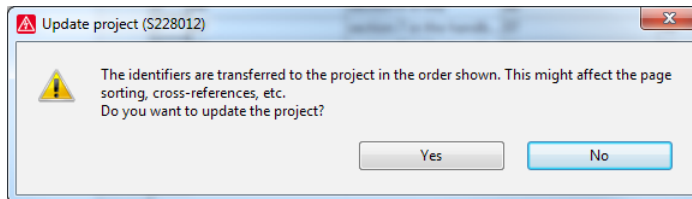


Fig. 7.24 Prompt after you click the **OK** button



**NOTE:** A kind of “interim save” (**APPLY** button) is helpful when editing the identifier structure so you do not lose all changes.

### 7.1.5 Configure protection (protect identifiers from changes)

Apart from the functions already described, EPLAN also allows for the option of preventing identifiers from being changed.

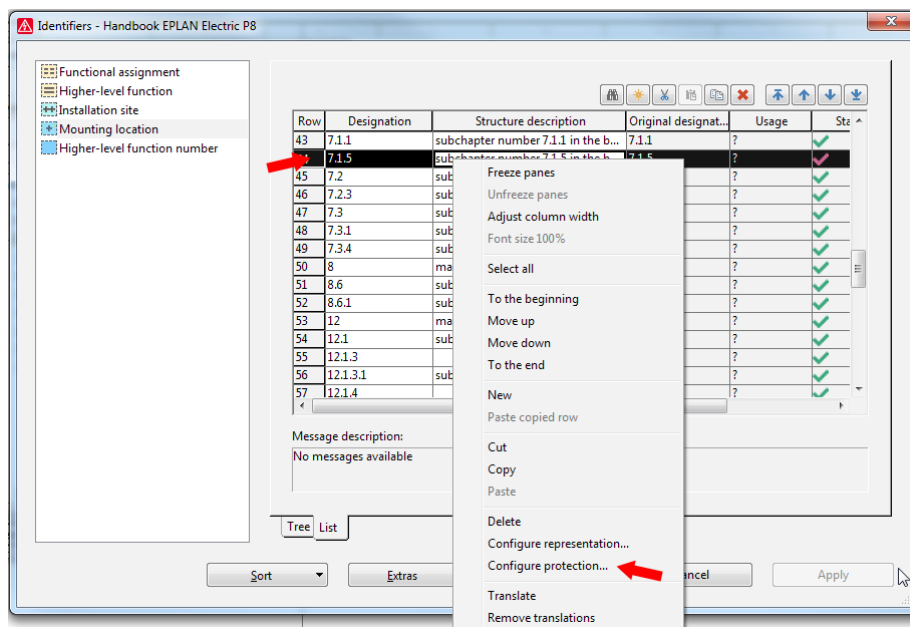


Fig. 7.25 Popup menu – Configure protection function

If you select the identifier and call the *Configure protection* function from the popup menu, EPLAN opens the **CONFIGURE PROTECTION** dialog.

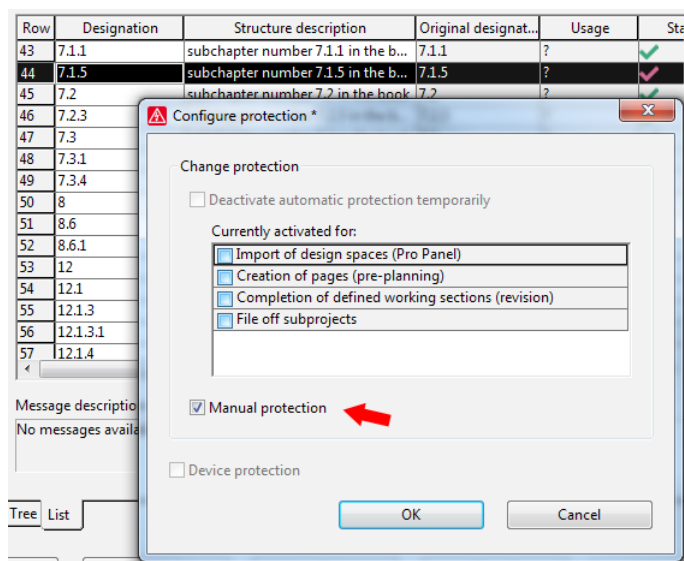


Fig. 7.26 Configure protection dialog



Here, you can now select the *Manual protection* check box. Once you click the OK button, this identifier will be protected from changes (change, delete, etc.) in structure identifier management.

EPLAN then gives this protected identifier a gray background.

| Row | Designation | Structure description               | Original designat... | Usage | Sta ^ |
|-----|-------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------|-------|-------|
| 43  | 7.1.1       | subchapter number 7.1.1 in the b... | 7.1.1                | ?     | ✓     |
| 44  | 7.1.5       | subchapter number 7.1.5 in the b... | 7.1.5                | ?     | ✓     |
| 45  | 7.2         | subchapter number 7.2 in the book   | 7.2                  | ?     | ✓     |
| 46  | 7.2.3       | subchapter number 7.2.3 in the b... | 7.2.3                | ?     | ✓     |
| 47  | 7.3         | subchapter number 7.3 in the book   | 7.3                  | ?     | ✓     |
| 48  | 7.3.1       | subchapter number 7.3.1 in the b... | 7.3.1                | ?     | ✓     |

Fig. 7.27 Protected identifier

## ■ 7.2 Message management

Why does message management exist? EPLAN is an online system, and message management is a perfect tool for immediately checking ( i.e. online) whether the action you have just performed was correct (depending on the project check settings).

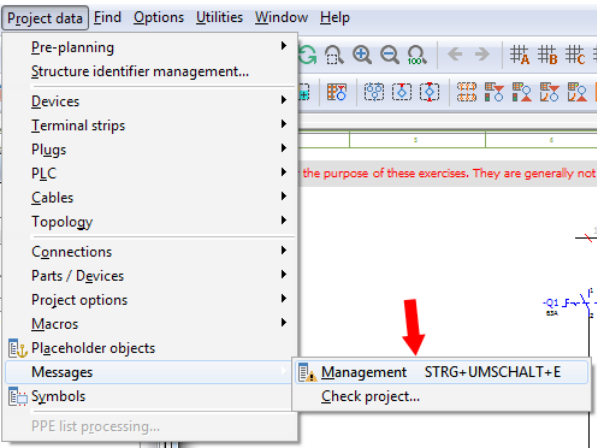


Fig. 7.28 Message management

Message management is started as an extra dialog via the **PROJECT DATA/MES-**  
**SAGES/MANAGEMENT** menu, or via a shortcut key, such as **CTRL + SHIFT + E**.

The **MESSAGE MANAGEMENT** dialog can be placed anywhere on the desktop and can be displayed/hidden via a (user-defined) keyboard shortcut such as **CTRL + SHIFT + E**. You do not need to keep this dialog open when editing projects. However, if you wish to

receive immediate notification of faulty data entries (depending on the types of checks set), then you should keep message management open.



**TIP:** The greater the number of online checks in message management, the slower project and/or graphical editing may be. Therefore, you should hide the dialog unless you need it.

When project editing is almost finished and the project is to be checked for faulty entries, the dialog can be displayed for extra information, since all **Errors**, **Warnings**, and **Notes** generated by the corresponding **Check run** are listed here.

| Message management - Handbook EPLAN Electric P8 |        |          |        |                              |                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------|----------|--------|------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Row                                             | Status | Category | Number | Page                         | DT                                 |
| 2942                                            | !      | W        | 004030 | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6/3  | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6-A2:AL... |
| 2943                                            | !      | W        | 004030 | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6/3  | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6-A2:AL... |
| 2944                                            | !      | W        | 004030 | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6/3  | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6-A2:AL... |
| 2945                                            | !      | E        | 004020 | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6/3  | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6-A2:AL... |
| 2946                                            | !      | W        | 004030 | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6/3  | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6-A2:AL... |
| 2947                                            | !      | N        | 004024 | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6/3  | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6-A2:C...  |
| 2948                                            | !      | N        | 004024 | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6/3  | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6-A2:C...  |
| 2949                                            | !      | N        | 004019 | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6/10 | ==Example=Chapter++05+5.6-A2:DL... |

Fig. 7.29 Message management

When you start editing a project in EPLAN, various actions, such as inserting entire pages from other projects or inserting existing macros into the project, can result in unwanted data in the various databases. For example, unwanted device combinations may be created or new structure identifiers may be added to the project. You cannot really avoid the creation of such data that does not really belong to the project without being constantly “interrupted” in your actual project editing. To make sure that you do not forget to change this unwanted data, EPLAN provides an online monitoring feature, or you can use manual check runs to check the project using a specified check-run scheme (offline) and generate messages in the message database.

### 7.2.1 The visual appearance of message management

The dialog supports the user with the following features: Display of the message type, the message priority, and other information such as a brief message description or the jump point to the faulty position in the project. Small colored icons make it easy to visually distinguish between the different types of messages.

|  |         |                                                       |
|--|---------|-------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Error   | For example: “Duplicate connection point description” |
|  | Warning | For example: “Connection point description missing”   |
|  | Note    | For example: “A placement lies outside the range”     |